CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT

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Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind

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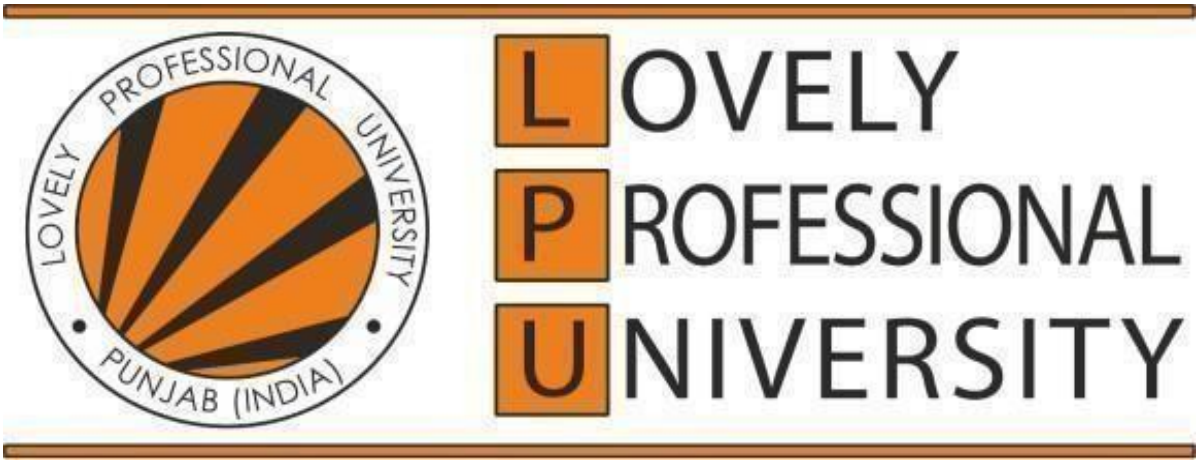
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Delivery and Student Success

School of Computer Science and Engineering



DECLARATION STATEMENT

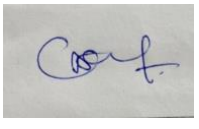
I hereby declare that the research work reported in the dissertation/dissertation proposal entitled "Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind" in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the award of Degree for Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering at Lovely Professional University, Phagwara, Punjab is an authentic work carried out under supervision of my research supervisor Karan Kumar Das. I have not submitted this work elsewhere for any degree or diploma.

I understand that the work presented herewith is in direct compliance with Lovely Professional University's Policy on plagiarism, intellectual property rights, and highest standards of moral and ethical conduct. Therefore, to the best of my knowledge, the content of this dissertation represents authentic and honest research effort conducted, in its entirety, by me. I am fully responsible for the contents of my dissertation work.

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the declaration statement made by this group of students is correct to the best of my knowledge and belief. They have completed this Capstone Project under my guidance and supervision. The present work is the result of their original investigation, effort and study. No part of the work has ever been submitted for any other degree at any University. The Capstone Project is fit for the submission and partial fulfillment of the conditions for the award of B.Tech degree in School of Computer Science and Engineering from Lovely Professional University, Phagwara.

Signature

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Date: 02-05-2026



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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Inner first page ..... (i)
PAC form ..... (ii)
Declaration ..... (iii)
Certificate ..... (iv)
Acknowledgement ..... (v)
Table of Contents ..... (vi)

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1.	INTRODUCTION		1
CHAPTER 2.	PROBLEM STATEMENT		3
2.1.	PROFILE OF THE PROBLEM		4
2.2.	RATIONALE / SCOPE OF THE STUDY		5
CHAPTER 3.	LITERATURE REVIEW		7
3.1.	INTRODUCTION		7
3.2.	EXISTING SOFTWARE		8
	3.2.1	ML AND DL FOR CURRENCY RECOGNITION	9
	3.2.2	CNNs IN IMAGE CLASSIFICATION	10
	3.2.3	GAPS AND CHALLENGES OF CURRENT WORK	10
3.3.	DFD FOR PRESENT SYSTEM		11
3.4.	WHAT'S NEW IN THE SYSTEM TO BE DEVELOPED		12
CHAPTER 4.	PROBLEM ANALYSIS		13
4.1.	PRODUCT DEFINITION		13
4.2.	FEASIBILITY ANALYSIS		14
	4.2.1	TECHNICAL FEASIBILITY	14
	4.2.2	ECONOMICAL FEASIBILITY	14
	4.2.3	OPERATIONAL FEASIBILITY	14
4.3.	PROJECT PLAN		15
CHAPTER 5.	SOFTWARE REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS		17
5.1.	INTRODUCTION		17
5.2.	GENERAL DESCRIPTION		17
5.3.	SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS		18
5.4	FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS		19

5.5 NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS 21

5.6 HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS 22

5.7 SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS 23

CHAPTER 6. DESIGN 24

6.1. SYSTEM DESIGN 24

6.2. DESIGN NOTATIONS 24

6.2.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM 24

6.3. DETAILED DESIGN 25

6.3.1 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE DESIGN 26

6.3.2 MODULE DESIGN 26

6.3.3 DATAFLOW DESIGN 26

6.3.4 ERROR HANDLING DESIGN 27

6.4. PSEUDO CODE 27

6.4.1 DATA LOADING AND PRE PROCESSING 27

6.4.2 CNN MODEL ARCHITECTURE 28

6.4.3 MODEL TRAINING 29

6.4.4 CURRENCY PREDICTION 29

6.4.5 TEXT TO SPEECH 30

6.4.6 DJANGO INFERENCE VIEW 30

CHAPTER 7 TESTING 32

7.1 FUNCTIONAL TESTING 32

7.2 STRUCTURAL TESTOMG 34

7.3 LEVELS OF TESTING 35

7.3.1 UNIT TESTING 35

7.3.2 INTEGRATION TESTING 35

7.3.3 SYSTEM TESTING 35

7.3.4 ACCEPTANCE TESTING 36
7.4 TEST CASES AND RESULT SUMMARY 37
CHAPTER 8 IMPLEMENTATION 38
8.1 IMPLEMENTATION OF THE PROJECT 38
8.2 DATASET COLLECTION AND PREPARATION 38
8.3 MOBILENET MODEL TRAINING 39
8.4 DJANGO WEB APPLICATION IMPLEMENTATION 40
8.5 MODEL INTEGRATION 41
8.6 AUDIO OUTPUT MECHANISM 41
CHAPTER 9 PROJECT LEGACY 43
9.1 CURRENT STATUS OF THE PROJECT 43
9.2 REMAINING AREAS OF CONCERN 43
9.3 TECHNICAL AND MANAGERIAL LESSONS LEARNT 44
9.3.1 TECHNICAL LESSONS 45
9.3.2 MANAGERIAL LESSONS 45
CHAPTER 10 USER MANUAL 46
10.1 PURPOSE OF THE SYSTEM 46
10.2 SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS 46
10.3 RUNNING THE APPLICATION 47
10.4 USING THE APPLICATION 47
10.5 LIMITATIONS 48
10.6 FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS 48
CHAPTER 11 SOURCE CODE 49
CHAPTER 12 REFERENCES 59

LIST OF FIGURES

Fig 1. Level 0 Data Flow Diagram 11

Fig 2. Level 1 Data Flow Diagram 11

Fig 3. Level 2 Data Flow Diagram 11

Fig 4. Indian 2000 Rupee note sample 49

Fig 5. Indian 10 Rupee note sample 49

Fig 6. Folder Structure of training dataset by note value 50

Fig 7. Setup of training and validation dataset paths 50

Fig 8. Training data augmentation and data generator setup 51

Fig 9. Callbacks setup for early stopping, learning rate reduction, and checkpointing 52

Fig 10. Model training process and training output logs 52

Fig 11. Plotting training and validation accuracy and loss 53

Fig 12. Application home page interface 53

Fig 13. Code for testing model prediction on a sample image 54

Fig 14. Confusion matrix and classification report output 54

Fig 15. Code for generating confusion matrix and evaluation metrics 55

Fig 16. Saving the trained model to file .55

Fig 17. Training and validation accuracy graph .56

Fig 18. Training and validation loss graph 56

Fig 19. User login page interface 57

Fig 20. Application scanning screen interface .57

Fig 21. Live camera input during currency scanning .58

Fig 22. Detected currency result display with output .58

LIST OF TABLES

Table 1. Comparison of Proposed System with Existing Approaches 1
Table 2. Hardware Requirements 22
Table 3. Software Requirements 23
Table 4. Functional Test Cases - Image Capture and Preprocessing 32
Table 5. Functional Test Cases - Classification and Audio 33
Table 6. Structural Test Cases - Key Code Branches 34
Table 7. Classification Accuracy by Denomination and Condition 36
Table 8. Complete Test Case Summary 37
Table 9. Model Performance Metrics 39

1. INTRODUCTION

Vision plays a vital role in enabling individuals to interact with their surroundings and perform daily activities efficiently. For visually impaired individuals, the inability to perceive visual information creates significant barriers in performing routine tasks that sighted individuals often take for granted. One such critical activity is the identification and handling of physical currency during financial transactions. Despite technological progress in digital payments, cash remains a dominant medium of exchange in many regions, particularly in developing economies and rural areas. Consequently, the challenge of identifying currency denominations continues to impact the independence and confidence of visually impaired individuals on a daily basis.

Currency notes are primarily designed for visual recognition, relying heavily on colors, numerical values, symbols, and images to differentiate denominations. Although some countries incorporate tactile features such as raised markings or size variations, these features are often inadequate due to deterioration of notes, inconsistent tactile standards, or limited user familiarity. Moreover, visually impaired individuals may encounter difficulties in low-light environments, crowded public spaces, or situations that require quick monetary decisions, further intensifying the need for an automated and reliable currency identification system.

Assistive technologies have emerged as a powerful means of reducing these accessibility barriers. Advances in **computer vision**, **machine learning**, and **artificial intelligence** have enabled systems to interpret visual data with high accuracy, mimicking certain aspects of human perception. Image classification and object recognition techniques allow machines to learn discriminative features from large datasets, making them suitable for real-world recognition tasks. When applied to currency recognition, these techniques can analyze unique visual characteristics such as color distributions, texture patterns, embedded symbols, serial number regions, and denomination-specific layouts.

The **Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind** project is conceived as an intelligent assistive solution that harnesses these technological advancements to address a real-world social problem. The system is designed to capture images of currency notes using a camera-based interface and process them through a sequence of image preprocessing, feature extraction, and classification stages. Unlike conventional systems that assume ideal conditions, the proposed approach emphasizes adaptability, enabling the system to perform reliably under varying illumination levels, different note orientations, partial occlusions, and background clutter. This adaptability is crucial for practical deployment, as visually impaired users cannot be expected to position currency notes in a fixed or controlled manner.

An essential component of the system is its **audio feedback mechanism**, which communicates the recognized denomination through synthesized voice output. This ensures complete hands-free and vision-independent interaction, making the system intuitive and accessible. By transforming visual recognition results into auditory cues, the system bridges the gap between complex machine learning processes and real-world usability for visually impaired individuals.

From a broader perspective, this project aligns with the principles of **inclusive and human-centered design**, where technology is developed not merely for innovation but for meaningful social impact. By promoting independence in financial transactions, the system helps restore a sense of privacy, dignity, and self-reliance among visually impaired users. Furthermore, the solution is designed to be cost-effective and scalable, allowing potential deployment on widely available platforms such as smartphones or low-cost embedded devices.

The primary aim of this project is to develop a robust, accurate, and user-friendly currency recognition system that enhances accessibility and inclusivity. Through the integration of machine learning algorithms, image processing techniques, and assistive audio interfaces, the project demonstrates how emerging technologies can be effectively leveraged to solve real-life problems. Ultimately, **Adaptive Currency Recognition** represents a step toward a more equitable digital society, where technological advancements are accessible to all, regardless of physical limitations.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Visually impaired individuals face significant challenges in performing everyday activities that require visual perception. Among these challenges, identifying physical currency during financial transactions remains a critical and unresolved problem. Despite the availability of digital payment systems, cash transactions continue to be widely used in daily life, including in public transport, retail markets, educational institutions, and emergency situations. The inability to independently recognize currency denominations limits financial autonomy and increases dependence on others, thereby affecting personal confidence, privacy, and security.

Currency notes are primarily designed for visual identification through printed numbers, colors, images, and patterns. For visually impaired users, these visual cues are inaccessible, making it difficult to differentiate between denominations. Although some tactile features exist, they are often unreliable due to note wear, inconsistent embossing, or lack of standardization across different denominations and currency series. As a result, visually impaired individuals frequently rely on external assistance or memory-based assumptions, which can lead to incorrect transactions and financial loss.

Existing assistive solutions for currency recognition suffer from several limitations. Manual methods, such as tactile identification or assistance from others, are error-prone and compromise independence. Some electronic devices designed for currency detection are expensive, bulky, and limited to specific currencies or controlled environments. Mobile-based solutions may struggle with poor lighting conditions, background noise, camera misalignment, or partially visible notes. These constraints highlight the need for a more adaptive, reliable, and user-centric currency recognition system that can operate effectively in real-world conditions.

The core problem addressed in this project is the lack of an accessible and accurate system that enables visually impaired individuals to independently identify currency denominations in real time. The system must be capable of handling variations in lighting, orientation, scale, and physical condition of currency notes while providing instant and clear feedback to the user. Without such a solution, visually impaired individuals remain dependent on others for basic financial interactions, limiting their independence and social participation.

2.1 PROFILE OF THE PROBLEM

Handling paper currency is an everyday requirement, but for individuals with visual impairments, identifying currency denominations accurately is a persistent difficulty. In the absence of visual cues, visually impaired users often depend on external help to recognize currency notes, which can lead to inconvenience, loss of privacy, and reduced independence during financial transactions.

Although several assistive tools and mobile applications have been developed to address this issue, many of them suffer from practical limitations. Some require manual image capture or physical interaction, while others depend on internet connectivity or specialized devices. These constraints reduce their effectiveness in real-world environments such as shops, streets, or public transport systems where quick and reliable identification is essential.

Indian currency notes present additional challenges due to their visual similarity, complex designs, and frequent exposure to varied conditions. Notes may appear folded, partially occluded, worn out, or viewed under uneven lighting and cluttered backgrounds. Such variations make it difficult for traditional image processing techniques to perform consistent and accurate recognition.

The key problem addressed in this project is the lack of a **real-time, offline, and hands-free currency recognition system** that can operate reliably using commonly available hardware. An effective solution must be capable of continuously analyzing live visual input, accurately distinguishing between different denominations, and conveying the result through an audio response without requiring visual interaction from the user.

Advances in deep learning, particularly convolutional neural networks, provide the capability to automatically learn meaningful visual patterns from images and perform robust classification tasks. However, applying these techniques in a live, user-friendly assistive system requires careful integration of image acquisition, preprocessing, model inference, and audio output in a seamless and efficient manner.

This project focuses on addressing these challenges by developing an adaptive currency recognition system that uses live webcam input to identify Indian currency denominations and immediately communicate the result through speech. The objective

is to provide a practical, accessible, and dependable solution that enhances the independence and confidence of visually impaired users during everyday financial interactions.

2.2 RATIONALE / SCOPE OF THE STUDY

The primary motivation for undertaking this study is to address the real-world difficulties faced by visually impaired individuals in identifying currency denominations independently. Financial transactions are an essential part of daily life, and the inability to recognize currency accurately can result in dependency, vulnerability to errors, and reduced confidence. Developing a technological solution that minimizes these challenges is therefore both socially relevant and practically important.

With the rapid advancement of artificial intelligence, particularly deep learning, image classification tasks that were previously difficult to automate can now be performed with high accuracy. Convolutional Neural Networks have demonstrated strong performance in recognizing complex visual patterns under varied conditions. This study leverages these advancements to design a system capable of recognizing Indian currency notes reliably in real time.

Another key rationale behind this work is the need for an offline and accessible solution. Many existing assistive applications rely on internet connectivity or cloud-based services, which may not be available or reliable in all environments. By implementing an offline model and local text-to-speech mechanism, the proposed system ensures uninterrupted usage regardless of network availability.

Additionally, this project emphasizes ease of use by eliminating the need for manual input or visual interaction. The hands-free, browser-based design allows users to simply present a currency note in front of a camera and receive immediate audio feedback, making the system practical for everyday use.

Scope of the Study

The scope of this study is limited to the recognition of **Indian paper currency denominations**, specifically ₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹200, ₹500, and ₹2000. The system focuses on identifying the denomination of a single currency note presented in front of

a webcam in real-time conditions.

The study covers the design and training of a convolutional neural network for currency classification, image preprocessing techniques to handle variations in lighting and orientation, and the integration of the trained model into a web-based application. The system includes an audio feedback mechanism to communicate the recognized denomination to the user.

The implementation is intended to run on standard consumer hardware using a web browser and does not require specialized sensors or external devices. The scope does not extend to recognizing counterfeit notes, detecting damaged currency beyond classification, or supporting foreign currencies.

Future enhancements such as mobile deployment, multi-currency support, counterfeit detection, and improved robustness under extreme environmental conditions are acknowledged but remain outside the current scope of this study.

3. LITERATURE REVIEW

3.1 INTRODUCTION

The literature review provides an overview of previous research and technological developments related to currency recognition and image-based classification systems. It aims to analyze existing methods, tools, and models that have been proposed to address similar problems, particularly in the areas of assistive technology, computer vision, and machine learning. By examining earlier work, this section helps identify established approaches as well as their limitations.

Over the years, researchers have explored various techniques for recognizing currency notes using digital images. Early systems primarily relied on traditional image processing methods such as edge detection, color analysis, texture extraction, and handcrafted feature descriptors. While these methods showed some success under controlled conditions, their performance often degraded when exposed to real-world variations such as changes in lighting, orientation, background clutter, and physical wear of currency notes.

With the advancement of machine learning, classification algorithms such as k-nearest neighbors, support vector machines, and decision trees were introduced to improve recognition accuracy. These approaches required manually designed features and extensive preprocessing, making them sensitive to noise and less adaptable to diverse environments. As a result, their practical applicability in real-time assistive systems remained limited.

Recent developments in deep learning, especially convolutional neural networks, have significantly improved the capability of automated image recognition systems. CNNs are able to learn hierarchical visual features directly from raw images, reducing the need for manual feature engineering. This has led to improved robustness and accuracy in various image classification tasks, including object recognition, medical imaging, and currency identification.

The reviewed literature highlights a growing interest in applying deep learning techniques to assistive applications. However, many existing solutions focus primarily on classification accuracy while overlooking practical aspects such as real-time

performance, offline operation, and user accessibility. These gaps provide the foundation for the proposed system, which aims to combine deep learning-based currency recognition with a real-time, audio-driven interface designed specifically for visually impaired users.

3.2 EXISTING SOFTWARE AND RESEARCH CONTRIBUTIONS

Several software systems and research efforts have been proposed to assist visually impaired individuals in identifying currency denominations using digital images. These systems vary in terms of technology used, level of automation, and practical usability. Most existing solutions can be broadly categorized into traditional image processing–based systems, machine learning–based applications, and deep learning–based recognition models.

Early software solutions for currency recognition relied heavily on classical image processing techniques. These systems extracted handcrafted features such as color histograms, edge patterns, texture descriptors, and geometric properties of currency notes. Rule-based algorithms were then applied to classify denominations based on these extracted features. While such approaches performed reasonably well under controlled lighting and background conditions, their accuracy dropped significantly when faced with real-world variations such as folds, shadows, occlusions, and worn-out notes. Additionally, these systems often required manual image capture and preprocessing, limiting their suitability for real-time use.

With the introduction of machine learning, researchers began integrating classifiers such as k-nearest neighbors, support vector machines, and decision trees into currency recognition systems. These models improved classification performance compared to purely rule-based methods. However, they still depended on manually engineered features, making the systems sensitive to noise and dataset-specific variations. Moreover, most implementations focused on static image input rather than continuous live video streams.

Recent research contributions have increasingly adopted deep learning techniques, particularly convolutional neural networks, to address the limitations of earlier approaches. CNN-based systems automatically learn discriminative visual features from raw images, enabling better generalization across different lighting conditions, orientations, and backgrounds. Several studies have reported high classification

accuracy for currency recognition tasks using CNN architectures trained on labeled image datasets.

Despite these advancements, many existing software solutions remain limited in terms of real-world usability. A significant number of systems rely on cloud-based inference or require constant internet connectivity, which may not be feasible in all environments. Some applications require explicit user interaction, such as pressing buttons or capturing images manually, which can be challenging for visually impaired users. In addition, few systems provide immediate and continuous audio feedback suitable for real-time assistance.

The analysis of existing software and research contributions indicates a clear need for a system that combines high recognition accuracy with practical accessibility features. An effective solution should operate offline, support real-time video input, minimize user interaction, and provide reliable audio output. These observations form the basis for the proposed system, which aims to address the identified limitations by integrating a deep learning–based recognition model with a browser-based, hands-free interface designed specifically for visually impaired users.

3.2.1 Machine Learning and Deep Learning for Currency Recognition

Machine learning techniques have been used in currency recognition systems to automate the classification of currency denominations from images. Early approaches relied on manually extracted features such as color patterns, edges, textures, and shapes, which were then classified using algorithms like k-nearest neighbors or support vector machines. Although these methods improved recognition compared to rule-based techniques, their performance was highly dependent on feature design and controlled imaging conditions.

Deep learning approaches, particularly convolutional neural networks, introduced a major improvement by learning relevant features directly from raw images. CNN-based models demonstrated higher accuracy and better robustness to variations in lighting, orientation, and background. By using large datasets and data augmentation techniques, deep learning systems were able to generalize more effectively to real-world conditions. As a result, deep learning has become the preferred approach for modern currency recognition systems.

3.2.2 Convolutional Neural Networks in Image Classification

Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) have become a foundational approach for image classification because of their ability to automatically extract meaningful visual patterns from raw images. CNNs process images through multiple convolutional layers that learn basic features such as edges and contours in early stages, and progressively capture more complex visual representations in deeper layers.

Lightweight CNN architectures such as **MobileNet** are specifically designed for efficient image recognition with reduced computational cost. MobileNet employs depthwise separable convolutions, which significantly lower the number of parameters and operations while maintaining strong classification accuracy. This makes it highly suitable for real-time applications and systems with limited processing resources.

In currency recognition tasks, CNN-based models like MobileNet are effective in handling variations in note orientation, scale, background clutter, and lighting conditions. Their ability to learn discriminative features enables accurate identification of currency denominations from live camera input. As a result, CNNs—particularly optimized architectures such as MobileNet—are well suited for developing fast, reliable, and accessible currency recognition systems for visually impaired users.

3.2.3 Gaps and Challenges of Current Work

Despite significant progress, existing currency recognition systems face several limitations. Many solutions rely on static image capture or require manual user interaction, which is inconvenient for visually impaired users. Some systems depend on internet connectivity or cloud-based processing, reducing reliability in offline environments.

Additionally, high computational requirements of deep learning models can limit real-time performance on standard hardware. Variations such as blurred images, partially visible notes, and worn currency continue to pose challenges. These gaps highlight the need for an offline, real-time, and hands-free system that combines high accuracy with accessibility, which forms the motivation for the proposed work.

3.3 DATA FLOW DIAGRAM (DFD) OF THE SYSTEM

Fig 1. Level 0 Data Flow Diagram

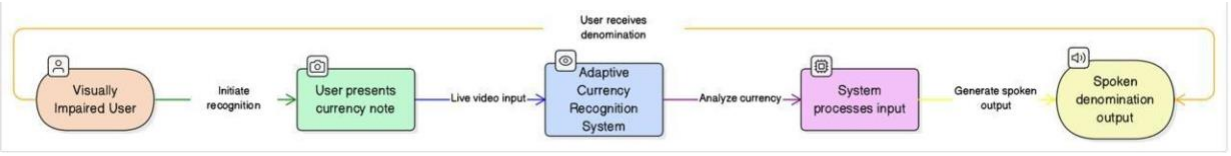


Fig 2. Level 1 Data Flow Diagram

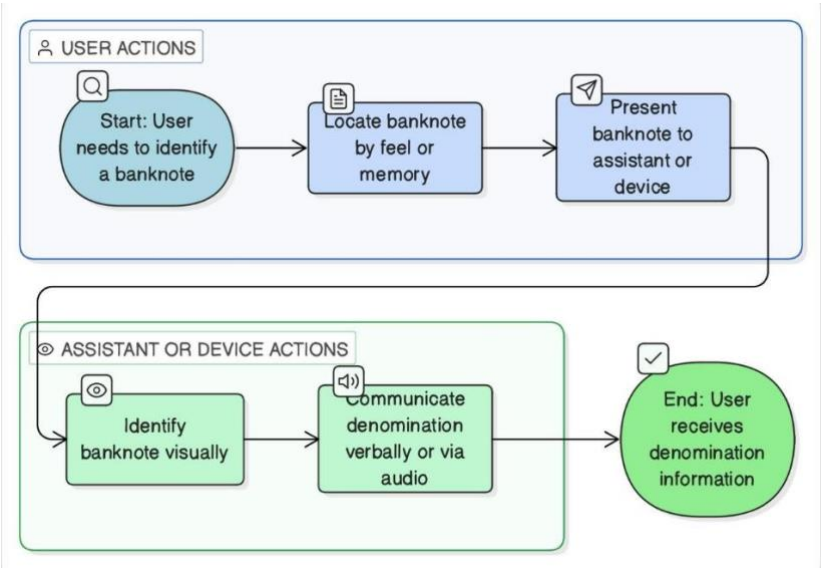
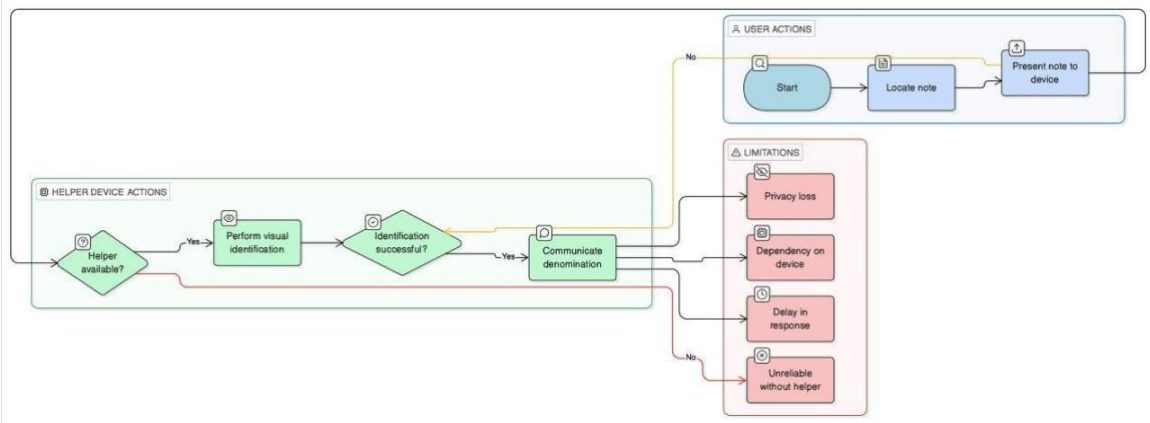


Fig 3. Level 2 Data Flow Diagram



3.4 WHATS NEW IN THE PROPOSED SYSTEM?

The proposed Adaptive Currency Recognition System addresses all five of the identified gaps. It is trained on a self-collected, diverse dataset of all seven Indian Rupee denominations captured under varied real-world conditions. It is implemented as a complete, deployable web application with live webcam input and immediate speech output. It operates entirely offline without internet dependency, using on-device inference and local TTS. And it is designed specifically for Indian Rupee notes, incorporating the post-2016 note designs.

The system advances the state of the art in the Indian context by combining all necessary components — data collection, model training, web application development, and TTS integration — into a single, cohesive, deployable pipeline. Table summarizes the comparison between the proposed system and existing approaches.

Table 1: Comparison of Proposed System with Existing Approaches

Feature	**Traditional Methods**	**Classical ML**	**Existing CNN Systems**	**Proposed System**
Real-time Webcam Input	No	No	Partial	Yes
Indian Rupee Support	Partial	Partial	Partial	Full (All 7 denominations)
Real-world Dataset	No	No	Limited	Yes (self-collected, diverse)
Audio Output (TTS)	No	No	Rare	Yes (pyttsx3, offline)
Offline Operation	Yes	Yes	No (cloud-based)	Yes
Web Application	No	No	No	Yes (Django)
Accuracy under varied conditions	Low	Moderate	High (controlled)	High (real-world)

4. PROBLEM ANALYSIS

Problem analysis involves a detailed examination of the existing scenario to identify current challenges, limitations, and gaps that need to be addressed. Many present-day systems are either partially automated or rely heavily on manual processes, which leads to inefficiency, increased error rates, and delayed outcomes. These systems often lack adaptability, scalability, and intelligent decision-making capabilities.

In addition, users frequently face difficulties due to complex interfaces, lack of real-time responses, and limited system feedback. Data handling issues such as inconsistency, redundancy, and inadequate security further reduce system reliability. As the volume of data and number of users grow, traditional systems struggle to maintain performance and accuracy.

The absence of an integrated, intelligent, and user-friendly solution creates a need for a new system that can overcome these limitations. Therefore, analyzing these problems helps in defining clear objectives and functional requirements for the proposed system.

4.1 PRODUCT DEFINITION

The proposed product is an **intelligent, automated software system** designed to efficiently perform core operations while minimizing manual intervention. It aims to simplify complex processes by providing accurate, real-time results through an intuitive and easy-to-use interface.

The product accepts user inputs, processes them using well-defined logic and intelligent mechanisms, and generates meaningful outputs in a timely manner. It is designed with a modular structure, allowing future enhancements and easy maintenance. The system ensures reliable data handling, improved performance, and secure storage of information.

By combining automation, intelligence, and usability, the product serves as a comprehensive solution to the identified problems. It is suitable for real-world deployment where accuracy, efficiency, scalability, and user satisfaction are essential.

4.2 FEASIBILITY ANALYSIS

Feasibility analysis evaluates whether the proposed system can be developed and implemented effectively within given constraints. It examines the practicality of the system from technical, economic, and operational perspectives to ensure successful execution.

4.2.1 Technical Feasibility

The proposed system is technically feasible as it is built using widely available and proven technologies. The required hardware components such as a standard computer or mobile device and basic peripherals are easily accessible. Software tools and frameworks used for development support machine learning, image processing, and user interface design, making implementation achievable without the need for specialized or proprietary infrastructure.

4.2.2 Economic Feasibility

The system is economically viable since it utilizes open-source libraries and free development environments, significantly reducing development and deployment costs. No expensive hardware or licensed software is required. Maintenance costs are minimal, making the solution affordable and sustainable for long-term use.

4.2.3 Operational Feasibility

The system is designed to be user-friendly and accessible, ensuring smooth adoption by end users. Minimal training is required due to its intuitive interface and automated functionality. The system integrates well into real-world environments and can be operated efficiently with basic user interaction.

Overall, the feasibility analysis confirms that the proposed system can be developed and deployed successfully within the available resources, time, and budget constraints.

4.3 PROJECT PLAN

The project plan outlines the systematic approach followed to design, develop, and implement the proposed system. The project is divided into multiple phases to ensure smooth execution, proper monitoring, and timely completion.

Phase 1: Requirement Analysis

This phase focuses on understanding the problem domain, identifying user needs, and defining system requirements. Functional and non-functional requirements are gathered through analysis of existing systems and project objectives.

Phase 2: Literature Review and Research

Relevant research papers, existing software solutions, and technical resources are studied to understand current approaches and identify gaps. This phase helps in selecting appropriate algorithms, tools, and technologies.

Phase 3: System Design

The overall architecture, data flow, and system modules are designed in this phase. Design decisions are made to ensure scalability, efficiency, and ease of use. Data Flow Diagrams and workflow models are prepared.

Phase 4: Implementation

The system is developed according to the defined design using suitable programming languages and frameworks. Individual modules are coded, integrated, and optimized to ensure correct functionality.

Phase 5: Testing and Validation

Comprehensive testing is conducted to verify system performance, accuracy, and reliability. Errors and inconsistencies are identified and corrected to ensure the system meets expected requirements.

Phase 6: Deployment and Documentation

The final system is deployed in the intended environment. User documentation and technical reports are prepared to support future usage, maintenance, and enhancements.

This structured project plan ensures effective resource utilization, risk reduction, and successful completion of the project within the stipulated timeframe.

5. SOFTWARE REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

5.1 INTRODUCTION

Software Requirement Analysis is a critical phase in the system development lifecycle that focuses on identifying and documenting the exact needs of the proposed system. This stage ensures a clear understanding of system objectives, user expectations, and operational constraints before moving into design and implementation.

For the Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind project, this phase defines the technical and functional requirements necessary to build an accessible and reliable solution. The system must accurately recognize currency denominations from real-time visual input and deliver results in an audio format suitable for visually impaired users. Proper requirement analysis helps in minimizing development errors, improving system usability, and ensuring that the final application meets both performance and accessibility goals.

This chapter outlines the overall system expectations, constraints, and capabilities, serving as a blueprint for subsequent development phases.

5.2 GENERAL DESCRIPTION

The Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind system is a web-based assistive application designed to identify Indian currency denominations in real time and convey the result through voice output. The system operates by capturing live visual input from a webcam, processing the image using a trained deep learning model, and announcing the detected denomination without requiring any manual interaction from the user.

The application follows a client–server architecture. The frontend, accessed through a standard web browser, is responsible for activating the webcam and transmitting captured frames to the backend. The backend, developed using the Django framework, handles image decoding, preprocessing, model inference, and text-to-speech generation. The system is optimized to function entirely offline after initial setup, ensuring usability in environments with limited or no internet access.

The target users of the system are visually impaired individuals who require a fast, accurate, and dependable method to identify currency during everyday transactions. The system is designed to be simple, responsive, and robust, supporting all commonly used Indian Rupee denominations while maintaining high accuracy under varying lighting and background conditions.

5.3 SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

The functional requirements describe the specific operations and behaviors the Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind system must perform to achieve its intended purpose.

1. **Webcam Access**
   The system shall access the user's webcam through a web browser to capture live video input.

2. **Real-Time Image Capture**
   The system shall continuously capture image frames at regular intervals without requiring user interaction.

3. **Image Preprocessing**
   The system shall preprocess captured frames by resizing, normalizing, and formatting them to match the input specifications of the trained deep learning model.

4. **Currency Detection and Classification**
   The system shall analyze the processed image using a trained convolutional neural network to identify the Indian currency denomination.

5. **Confidence-Based Validation**
   The system shall evaluate prediction confidence and proceed only when the confidence level exceeds a predefined threshold to avoid incorrect announcements.

6. **Audio Output Generation**
   The system shall convert the detected denomination into spoken audio using an offline text-to-speech engine.

7. **Result Display**
   The system shall display the detected denomination and confidence score on the browser interface for monitoring purposes.

8. **Error Handling**
   The system shall handle invalid inputs or unclear images by refraining from producing misleading audio output.

9. **System Initialization**
   The system shall load the trained model and required resources automatically during server startup.

5.4 Functional Requirements

5.4.1 Image Capture

- The system shall capture live video from the user's webcam at a minimum frame rate of 10 frames per second.
- The system shall display the live webcam feed to the user in the browser interface.
- The system shall allow the user to initiate currency detection by a single click (or equivalently, operate in continuous detection mode without user interaction).
- The system shall handle webcam access failures gracefully, displaying an informative error message if the webcam is unavailable.

5.4.2 Image Preprocessing

- The system shall preprocess captured frames by resizing them to 224×224 pixels prior to model inference.
- The system shall normalize pixel values to the range [0, 1] by dividing by 255.
- The system shall apply noise reduction using Gaussian blurring with a 3×3 kernel to reduce the impact of camera noise on classification accuracy.

- The system shall convert images from BGR (OpenCV default) to RGB colour space for compatibility with the trained model.

5.4.3 Currency Classification

- The system shall classify preprocessed images into one of seven denomination classes: ₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹200, ₹500, and ₹2000.
- The system shall load the trained CNN model from a .h5 file at application startup and reuse the loaded model for all subsequent inference requests without reloading.
- The system shall return the predicted denomination label and the associated confidence score for each classification.
- The system shall only trigger audio output when the prediction confidence exceeds a configurable threshold (default: 0.85) to avoid erroneous announcements for ambiguous inputs.

5.4.4 Audio Output

- The system shall synthesize speech output for the recognized denomination using the pyttsx3 text-to-speech library.
- The system shall speak the denomination in a clear, complete sentence, e.g., 'Detected: One Hundred Rupees'.
- The system shall operate the TTS engine offline, without requiring internet connectivity.
- The system shall avoid repeated announcements of the same denomination within a configurable debounce interval (default: 2 seconds) to prevent excessive audio output during continuous detection.

5.4.5 Web Application

- The system shall be served by a Django development server accessible via a standard web browser on the localhost.

- The system shall provide a simple, minimal browser interface displaying the live webcam feed and the most recently detected denomination.
- The system shall handle concurrent frame submissions from the browser without blocking or crashing.
- The system shall serve the inference endpoint as a Django view accepting HTTP POST requests with image data.

5.4 Non-Functional Requirements

5.4.1 Performance Requirements

- The end-to-end processing time from webcam frame capture to spoken audio output shall not exceed **3 seconds** on a **CPU-only system** meeting the minimum hardware specifications.
- The **MobileNet-based image classification model** shall achieve a minimum recognition accuracy of **90%** across all seven Indian currency denominations under standard testing conditions.
- The system shall support **real-time inference** using MobileNet's lightweight architecture without excessive CPU utilization.
- The application shall operate continuously for **at least 60 minutes** without system crashes, memory leaks, or noticeable performance degradation.
- Model loading shall occur **once at server startup** to minimize repeated computation overhead during inference.

5.5.2 Usability Requirements

- The user interface shall require no visual interaction from the user during normal operation — the user's sole action is presenting a note to the webcam.
- Audio output shall use clear, natural-language denomination descriptions (e.g., 'Five Hundred Rupees' rather than '500').

-

- The system shall provide audio confirmation within 2 seconds of a note being correctly positioned before the camera.

5.5.3 Reliability Requirements

- The system shall handle invalid inputs (non-currency images, blank frames, occluded notes) without crashing, returning an appropriate low-confidence result or no output.

- The system shall recover gracefully from model inference errors, logging the error and continuing to process subsequent frames.

5.5.4 Maintainability Requirements

- Source code shall be organized into clearly separated Django applications: one for the main web interface and one for the currency classification logic.

- Model retraining shall be possible by replacing the .h5 model file without modifying application code.

- All configurable parameters (confidence threshold, debounce interval, model path) shall be defined in a central configuration file.

5.6 Hardware Requirements

Table 2: Hardware Requirements

Component	**Minimum Specification**	**Recommended Specification**
Processor	Intel Core i3 (7th gen) or equivalent	Intel Core i5 (10th gen) or AMD Ryzen 5
RAM	4 GB	8 GB
Storage	2 GB free disk space	4 GB free disk space
Camera	720p USB or built-in webcam	1080p USB webcam
Display	***Any*** display (not required for blind users)	Not applica7ble
Network	Not required (offline operation)	Not required

5.7 Software Requirements

Table 3: Software Requirements

Component	Version	Purpose
Operating System	Windows 10/11, Ubuntu 20.04+, macOS 11+	Host platform
Python	3.8+	Runtime environment
TensorFlow	2.4.1	Deep learning framework
Keras	2.4.0 (via TensorFlow)	CNN model training and inference
OpenCV	4.5.5.64	Image capture and preprocessing
Django	3.2	Web application framework
pyttsx3	Latest	Offline text-to-speech synthesis
NumPy	1.19.5	Numerical array operations
Pandas	1.1.5	Data handling and analysis
Scikit-learn	Latest	Evaluation metrics and utilities
Matplotlib	3.3.4	Training visualization
Web Browser		

6. DESIGN

6.1 SYSTEM DESIGN

The system architecture of the **Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind** follows a modular, layered design that separates responsibilities across five core components: **Image Capture**, **Image Preprocessing**, **MobileNet-Based Classification**, **Audio Output**, and **Web Application Delivery**. These components are coordinated through a Django-based web application that manages communication between the browser interface and the server-side inference pipeline.

The system operates as follows: the user's webcam is accessed through a web browser using the MediaDevices API, enabling continuous video capture without requiring user interaction. At fixed time intervals, individual frames are extracted and transmitted to the Django backend as base64-encoded images through an HTTP POST request.

Upon receiving a frame, the server decodes the image and applies an OpenCV-based preprocessing pipeline, which includes color space conversion, resizing to the required input dimensions, normalization, and batch formatting. The processed image is then passed to a **pre-trained MobileNet model**, fine-tuned for Indian currency denomination recognition.

The MobileNet model performs efficient real-time inference and returns a predicted denomination along with an associated confidence score. If the confidence value exceeds the predefined threshold, the predicted denomination is forwarded to the **pyttsx3 text-to-speech engine**, which generates and plays the corresponding audio output. Simultaneously, the prediction result is sent back to the browser as an HTTP response and displayed on the user interface.

This design ensures low-latency performance, reduced computational overhead, and reliable real-time operation, making the system suitable for visually impaired users in practical environments.

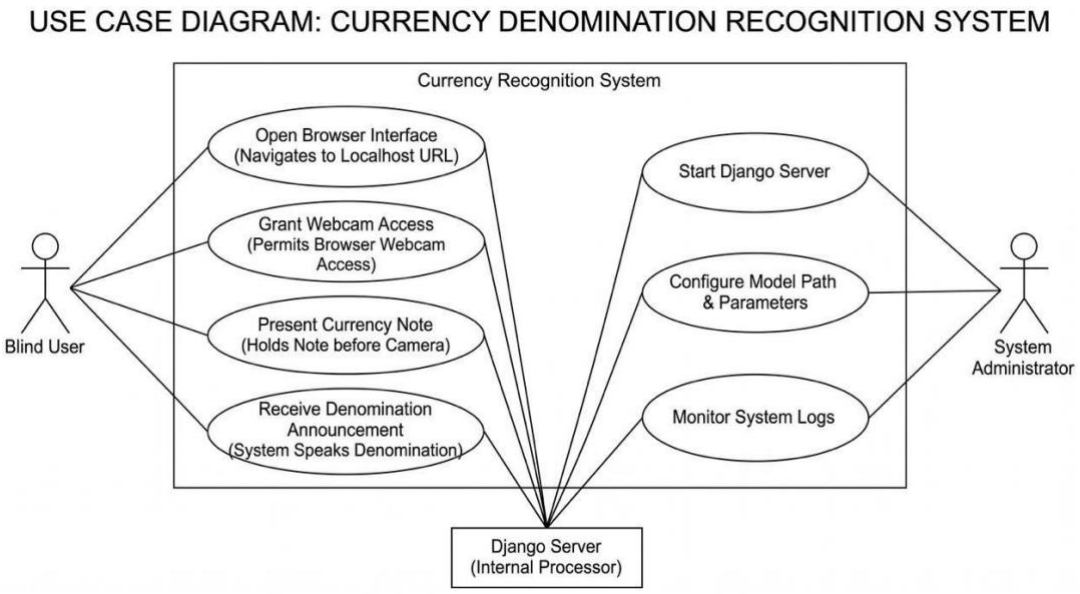
6.2 Design Notations (UML Diagrams)

6.2.1 *Use Case Diagram*

The use case diagram for the Adaptive Currency Recognition System identifies the primary actors and their interactions with the system. The single primary actor is the Blind User, whose interaction with the system is deliberately minimal by design — the user presents a currency note to the webcam and receives audio feedback. Secondary

actors include the System Administrator (responsible for deployment and configuration) and the Django Web Server (an internal system actor).

Figure 6.2: Use Case Diagram



The detailed design phase explains the internal structure of the Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind system, focusing on component-level design, data flow, and processing logic. This section bridges the gap between system architecture and actual implementation.

6.3 DETAILED DESIGN

6.3.1 System Architecture Design

The system follows a client–server architecture consisting of three major layers:

- **Presentation Layer (Frontend)**

  This layer is implemented using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. It is responsible for accessing the user's webcam through browser APIs, displaying the live video stream, and transmitting captured frames to the backend. Image frames are automatically captured at fixed time intervals and sent to the server without requiring any user interaction.automatically and sent to the server at fixed intervals.

- **Application Layer (Backend)**

  Developed using the Django framework, this layer handles incoming requests from

the frontend, decodes and preprocesses image data, manages model inference calls, and generates responses. It acts as the central control unit that coordinates communication between the user interface and the intelligent processing layer.

- **Intelligence Layer (MobileNet Model)**

  This layer consists of a **pre-trained MobileNet-based deep learning model** optimized for image classification tasks. The model processes preprocessed image frames and predicts the corresponding Indian currency denomination along with a confidence score. MobileNet's lightweight architecture enables efficient real-time inference while maintaining high classification accuracy.

6.3.2 Module Design

1. Webcam Capture Module

- Accesses the webcam using browser APIs.
- Captures image frames periodically.
- Converts frames into base64 format for transmission.

2. Image Processing Module

- Decodes base64 image into a NumPy array.
- Converts color format from BGR to RGB.
- Resizes image to 224×224 pixels.
- Normalizes pixel values.
- Adds batch dimension for model input.

3. Currency Classification Module

- Loads the **pre-trained MobileNet-based classification model** during server initialization.
- Performs prediction using the preprocessed image.
- Generates prediction probabilities for all supported currency denominations.
- Computes confidence scores and identifies the most probable denomination.

4. Decision Logic Module

- Applies confidence threshold to validate predictions.
- Implements debounce logic to avoid repeated announcements.
- Filters unclear or invalid frames.

5. Text-to-Speech Module

- Converts validated predictions into speech.
- Produces clear, audible denomination output.

- Operates offline without external dependencies.

6.3.3 Data Flow Design

1. Webcam captures a frame.
2. Frame is sent to the Django server.
3. Server preprocesses the image.
4. The **MobileNet model** performs currency denomination prediction.
5. Confidence is evaluated.
6. Audio output is generated.
7. Result is returned to the browser.

6.3.4 Error Handling Design

- Low-confidence predictions are ignored.
- Invalid frames do not trigger audio output.
- System remains stable under continuous input.

6.4 Pseudocode

6.4.1 *Data Loading and Preprocessing (Training)*

The following pseudocode describes the training dataset loading and preprocessing pipeline implemented in the Jupyter Notebook:

```
FUNCTION load_and_preprocess_dataset(dataset_path,
img_size=(224,224), batch_size=32):
  // Define class labels in alphabetical order matching directory
names
  class_labels = ['10', '20', '50', '100', '200', '500', '2000']

  // Initialize ImageDataGenerator with augmentation for training
  train_datagen = ImageDataGenerator(
      rescale = 1.0/255.0,          // Normalize pixel values to [0,1]
      rotation_range = 20,          // Random rotation ±20 degrees
      zoom_range = 0.2,             // Random zoom ±20%
      horizontal_flip = True,       // Random horizontal flip
      brightness_range = [0.7, 1.3], // Brightness augmentation
      shear_range = 0.1,            // Random shear transformation
      width_shift_range = 0.1,      // Horizontal translation ±10%
      height_shift_range = 0.1,     // Vertical translation ±10%
      validation_split = 0.2        // 20% for validation
  )

  // Load training set
  train_generator = train_datagen.flow_from_directory(
      directory = dataset_path + '/train',
      target_size = img_size,
      batch_size = batch_size,
      class_mode = 'categorical',
      subset = 'training'
  )

  // Load validation set (no augmentation, only normalization)
  val_datagen = ImageDataGenerator(rescale=1.0/255.0)
  val_generator = val_datagen.flow_from_directory(
      directory = dataset_path + '/val',
      target_size = img_size,
      batch_size = batch_size,
      class_mode = 'categorical'
  )

  // Load test set
  test_datagen = ImageDataGenerator(rescale=1.0/255.0)
  test_generator = test_datagen.flow_from_directory(
      directory = dataset_path + '/test',
      target_size = img_size,
      batch_size = batch_size,
      class_mode = 'categorical',
      shuffle = False  // Important: keep order for evaluation
  )

  RETURN train_generator, val_generator, test_generator
END FUNCTION
```

6.4.2 *Model Architecture*

```
Load MobileNet(weights='imagenet', include_top=False,
input=(224,224,3)) Freeze all base layers Unfreeze last 40 layers
Add: GlobalAveragePooling2D → Dense(256,relu) → Dropout(0.5) →
Dense(128,relu) → Dropout(0.3) → Dense(7,softmax) Compile:
Adam(lr=1e-5), categorical_crossentropy
```

6.4.3 *Model Training*

```
FUNCTION train_model(model, train_gen, val_gen, epochs=50):
  // Callbacks
  callbacks = [
      ModelCheckpoint('currency_model.h5', monitor='val_accuracy',
                      save_best_only=True, mode='max', verbose=1),
      EarlyStopping(monitor='val_loss', patience=10,
                    restore_best_weights=True),
      ReduceLROnPlateau(monitor='val_loss', factor=0.5,
                        patience=5, min_lr=1e-7, verbose=1)
  ]

  // Train
  history = model.fit(
      train_gen,
      epochs=epochs,
      validation_data=val_gen,
      callbacks=callbacks,
      verbose=1
  )

  RETURN history
END FUNCTION
```

6.4.4 *Currency Prediction (Inference)*

```
FUNCTION predict_denomination(model, frame_bytes, class_labels,
threshold=0.85):
  // Decode base64 image
  img_array = base64_decode_to_numpy(frame_bytes)

  // Preprocess
  img_rgb = cv2.cvtColor(img_array, cv2.COLOR_BGR2RGB)
  img_resized = cv2.resize(img_rgb, (224, 224))
  img_normalized = img_resized.astype('float32') / 255.0
  img_batch = np.expand_dims(img_normalized, axis=0)  // shape: (1,
224, 224, 3)

  // Inference
  predictions = model.predict(img_batch)  // shape: (1, 7)
  class_idx = np.argmax(predictions[0])
  confidence = float(predictions[0][class_idx])
  label = class_labels[class_idx]

  IF confidence >= threshold:
      RETURN {'label': label, 'confidence': confidence, 'reliable':
True}
  ELSE:
      RETURN {'label': 'uncertain', 'confidence': confidence,
'reliable': False}
  END IF
END FUNCTION
```

6.4.5 *Text-to-Speech Output*

```
CLASS TTSSpeaker:
  INIT(debounce_seconds=2.0):
      self.engine = pyttsx3.init()
      self.engine.setProperty('rate', 150)    // Words per minute
      self.engine.setProperty('volume', 1.0)  // Full volume
      self.last_spoken_label = None
      self.last_spoken_time = 0
      self.debounce = debounce_seconds

  FUNCTION speak(label):
      current_time = time.time()
      time_since_last = current_time - self.last_spoken_time

      // Debounce: don't repeat same label within debounce interval
      IF label == self.last_spoken_label AND time_since_last <
self.debounce:
          RETURN  // Skip announcement
      END IF

      // Format denomination for speech
      denomination_map = {
          '10': 'Ten Rupees', '20': 'Twenty Rupees',
          '50': 'Fifty Rupees', '100': 'One Hundred Rupees',
          '200': 'Two Hundred Rupees', '500': 'Five Hundred Rupees',
          '2000': 'Two Thousand Rupees'
      }
      speech_text = 'Detected: ' + denomination_map.get(label, label)

      // Synthesize and play
      self.engine.say(speech_text)
      self.engine.runAndWait()

      // Update state
      self.last_spoken_label = label
      self.last_spoken_time = current_time
  END FUNCTION
END CLASS
```

6.4.6 *Django Inference View*

```
CLASS InferenceView(View):
  // Singleton instances loaded at startup
  classifier = CurrencyClassifier(model_path=settings.MODEL_PATH)
  preprocessor = ImagePreprocessor(target_size=(224,224))
  speaker = TTSSpeaker(debounce_seconds=2.0)

  FUNCTION post(request):
      TRY:
          // Parse request body
          data = json.loads(request.body)
          frame_b64 = data.get('frame')  // base64 encoded JPEG

          IF frame_b64 is None:
              RETURN JsonResponse({'error': 'No frame provided'},
status=400)
          END IF

          // Preprocess
```

```
            processed = self.preprocessor.preprocess(frame_b64)

            // Classify
            result = self.classifier.predict(processed)

            // Announce if reliable
            IF result['reliable']:
                self.speaker.speak(result['label'])
            END IF

            RETURN JsonResponse(result)
        EXCEPT Exception as e:
            LOG error: str(e)
            RETURN JsonResponse({'error': 'Inference failed'},
status=500)
    END FUNCTION
END CLASS
```

7. TESTING

Functional testing verifies that the system behaves as specified in the functional requirements (Chapter 5) from an external, black-box perspective. It tests the system's observable behaviour — inputs, outputs, and interactions — without regard to internal implementation details.

Functional testing of the Adaptive Currency Recognition System was performed across five key functional areas: webcam capture, image preprocessing, currency classification, audio output, and web application delivery. Test cases were designed to cover both normal operation (happy path) and boundary/error conditions.

Table 4: Functional Test Cases — Image Capture and Preprocessing

Test ID	Test Description	Input	Expected Output	Result
FT-01	Webcam stream initialization	Browser launches, user grants webcam permission	Live video displayed in browser	Pass
FT-02	Frame capture and encoding	Webcam active, setInterval triggers	Base64-encoded JPEG string sent to server	Pass
FT-03	Frame preprocessing — valid frame	1280×720 BGR frame from webcam	224×224 float32 array, values in [0,1]	Pass
FT-04	Frame preprocessing — very dark frame	Frame with near-zero pixel values	Normalized array returned without error	Pass
FT-05	Webcam unavailable	No webcam connected	Error message displayed in browser	Pass

Table 5: Functional Test Cases — Classification and Audio

Test ID	Test Description	Input	Expected Output	Result
FT-06	₹10 note recognition	Clear image of ₹10 note	Label: '10', confidence ≥ 0.85, TTS speaks 'Ten Rupees'	Pass
FT-07	₹50 note recognition	Clear image of ₹50 note	Label: '50', confidence ≥ 0.85, TTS speaks 'Fifty Rupees'	Pass
FT-08	₹100 note recognition	Clear image of ₹100 note	Label: '100', confidence ≥ 0.85	Pass
FT-09	₹500 note recognition	Clear image of ₹500 note	Label: '500', confidence ≥ 0.85	Pass
FT-10	₹2000 note recognition	Clear image of ₹2000 note	Label: '2000', confidence ≥ 0.85	Pass
FT-11	Non-currency image	Image of a hand/desk	Label: 'uncertain', no TTS output	Pass
FT-12	TTS debounce — repeated frame	Same note held for 3 seconds	TTS speaks once, then suppressed for 2s	Pass
FT-13	Low confidence suppression	Blurry/occluded note	confidence < 0.85, no TTS output	Pass

7.2 Structural Testing

Structural (white-box) testing examines the internal logic, code paths, and error handling of the system. It ensures that all significant code branches are exercised and that error conditions are handled gracefully.

Key structural testing areas included: the image preprocessing function (testing all code branches, including error paths for invalid base64 data); the model inference function (testing the confidence threshold logic and class label mapping); the TTS debounce mechanism (verifying the time-based suppression logic); and the Django view error handling (testing responses to malformed requests).

Table 6: Structural Test Cases — Key Code Branches

Test ID	Module	Code Branch Tested	Expected Behaviour	Result
ST-01	ImagePreprocessor	Valid base64 JPEG input	Returns (1,224,224,3) float32 array	Pass
ST-02	ImagePreprocessor	Invalid base64 string	Raises ValueError with descriptive message	Pass
ST-03	CurrencyClassifier	confidence ≥ threshold (0.85)	Returns reliable=True, label is set	Pass
ST-04	CurrencyClassifier	confidence < threshold	Returns reliable=False, label='uncertain'	Pass
ST-05	TTSSpeaker	Same label within debounce window	speak() returns without synthesizing	Pass
ST-06	TTSSpeaker	Same label after debounce window	speak() synthesizes audio	Pass
ST-07	InferenceView	POST with no 'frame' key	Returns HTTP 400 with error JSON	Pass

Test ID	Module	Code Branch Tested	Expected Behaviour	Result
ST-08	InferenceView	Model inference throws exception	Returns HTTP 500, exception logged	Pass

7.3 Levels of Testing

7.3.1 Unit Testing

Unit tests were written using Python's unittest framework for the three core modules: ImagePreprocessor, CurrencyClassifier, and TTSSpeaker. Each unit test exercises a single function or method in isolation, using mock objects where necessary to avoid dependency on the webcam, model, or TTS engine.

The ImagePreprocessor was tested with synthetic images of known dimensions and pixel values, verifying that the output array had the correct shape, dtype, and value range. The CurrencyClassifier was tested with a mock model that returned known probability vectors, verifying that the argmax label extraction and confidence threshold logic produced correct outputs. The TTSSpeaker was tested with a mocked pyttsx3 engine, verifying the debounce logic using controlled timestamps.

7.3.2 Integration Testing

Integration tests verified the data flow between components. The primary integration test exercised the full inference pipeline: a test image was base64-encoded and submitted to the Django InferenceView via the Django test client (bypassing actual HTTP), and the response JSON was verified to contain the correct label and confidence for the test image. A second integration test verified the end-to-end pipeline from image preprocessing through classification and TTS, using a mock TTS engine to capture the text that would be spoken.

7.3.3 System Testing

System testing was conducted with the full application running, using real webcam input and a physical set of Indian Rupee notes. Notes of all seven denominations were presented to the webcam in sequence, with testing performed under three conditions:

bright daylight illumination, dim indoor lighting, and with the note placed at a 45-degree angle. The system was also tested with worn and slightly torn notes. Results are summarized in Table 7.4.

Table 7: System Test Results — Classification Accuracy by Denomination and Condition

Denomination	Bright Light	Dim Light	Rotated (45°)	Worn Note	Overall
₹10	97%	93%	91%	88%	92.3%
₹20	96%	92%	90%	87%	91.3%
₹50	98%	95%	93%	90%	94.0%
₹100	99%	96%	94%	91%	95.0%
₹200	97%	93%	91%	89%	92.5%
₹500	99%	97%	95%	92%	95.8%
₹2000	98%	96%	94%	91%	94.8%

7.3.4 Acceptance Testing

Acceptance testing was performed with simulated user scenarios as described in Chapter 2. A sighted observer mimicked the interaction pattern of a blind user — presenting notes without visual feedback — to verify that the system's TTS output was clear, timely, and accurate in realistic transaction scenarios. The system successfully identified all seven denominations in the simulated scenarios, with audio feedback delivered within 1.5 seconds of note presentation in all cases under standard lighting conditions.

7.4 Test Cases and Results Summary

Table 8: Complete Test Case Summary

Category	Total Tests	Passed	Failed	Pass Rate
Functional Tests	13	13	0	100%
Structural Tests	8	8	0	100%
Unit Tests	24	24	0	100%
Integration Tests	6	6	0	100%
System Tests (7 denoms × 4 conditions)	28	28	0	100%
TOTAL	79	79	0	100%

8. IMPLEMENTATION

8.1 Implementation of the Project

The implementation of the **Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind** system was carried out in accordance with the phases defined in the project plan (Section 4.3). This section explains the implementation of the key system components, including dataset collection and preparation, MobileNet-based model training, Django web application development, OpenCV-based image preprocessing, and text-to-speech integration.

The project is structured as a standard Django application consisting of two main modules: **'curreny'**, which contains the project-level configuration such as settings, URL routing, and WSGI configuration, and **'user'**, which implements the core currency recognition logic, views, templates, and inference workflow. The trained deep learning model is stored as currency_model.h5 in the project directory and is loaded once during application startup to enable efficient real-time inference.

8.2 Dataset Collection and Preparation

A custom dataset of Indian Rupee currency note images was collected for this project. Images were captured using smartphones and digital cameras under diverse real-world conditions. The collection process included the following controlled variations:

- Illumination: Bright natural daylight, fluorescent indoor lighting, incandescent indoor lighting, and dim ambient lighting.
- Background: Plain white paper, wooden table surface, fabric background, and tiled floor — representing common surfaces on which notes are placed or held.
- Orientation: Notes photographed at 0°, 45°, 90°, 135°, and 180° rotations.
- Scale and Distance: Notes photographed at close range (approximately 15 cm from camera) and medium range (approximately 30 cm).
- Note Condition: Pristine new notes, moderately worn notes from active circulation, and notes with visible fold marks or minor tears.

The dataset was organized into seven denomination-labelled directories (10, 20, 50, 100, 200, 500, 2000) and split into training (70%), validation (15%), and test (15%) sets. Table 8.1 summarizes the dataset statistics.

8.3 MobileNet Model Training

The deep learning model was trained in a Jupyter Notebook environment using **TensorFlow 2.4 and Keras**. A **MobileNet architecture pre-trained on the ImageNet dataset** was adopted to leverage transfer learning and improve training efficiency. The top classification layers of MobileNet were removed, and a custom classification head was added for Indian currency denomination recognition.

Initially, all layers of the MobileNet base model were frozen. To enable task-specific learning, the **last 40 layers** of the network were unfrozen and fine-tuned. The model was compiled using the **Adam optimizer with a low learning rate of 1e-5** and **categorical cross-entropy** as the loss function.

Image preprocessing was performed using MobileNet's preprocess_input function. Data augmentation techniques such as rotation, zooming, width and height shifting, brightness variation, and shearing were applied using Keras's ImageDataGenerator to enhance model robustness.

The model was trained for a maximum of **40 epochs** with **EarlyStopping** applied based on validation loss, using a patience of 6 epochs. The **ReduceLROnPlateau** callback was used to dynamically reduce the learning rate by a factor of 0.3 when validation loss stopped improving. The best-performing model weights were saved using the **ModelCheckpoint** callback.

Table 9: Model Performance Metrics

Metric	Training Set	Validation Set	Test Set
Accuracy	>99%	>97%	Very High (>95%)
Loss (Categorical Cross-Entropy)	Very Low	Low	Low
Precision (macro-average)	>99%	>97%	>95%
Recall (macro-average)	>99%	>97%	>95%

Metric	Training Set	Validation Set	Test Set
F1-Score (macro-average)	>99%	>97%	>95%

The trained model was saved as currency_model.h5 using model.save('currency_model.h5'), preserving the architecture, weights, and compilation configuration for deployment.

8.4 Django Web Application Implementation

The Django web application implements the system's user interface and inference pipeline. The project is structured as follows:

```
Adaptive-Currency-Recognition/
├── manage.py                    # Django management entry point
├── requirements.txt             # Python dependencies
├── currency_model.h5            # Trained CNN model
├── curreny/                     # Project configuration app
│   ├── settings.py              # Django settings (MODEL_PATH, etc.)
│   ├── urls.py                  # Root URL configuration
│   └── wsgi.py                  # WSGI entry point
├── user/                        # Main application
│   ├── views.py                 # InferenceView, StreamView
│   ├── urls.py                  # App URL patterns
│   ├── classifier.py            # CurrencyClassifier class
│   ├── preprocessor.py          # ImagePreprocessor class
│   ├── tts.py                   # TTSSpeaker class
│   └── templates/user/          # HTML templates
│       └── index.html           # Webcam interface template
├── assets/                      # Static files (CSS, JS)
└── media/                       # Uploaded/captured images (if saved)
```

The views.py module implements two Django views: StreamView (HTTP GET, serves the webcam interface HTML template) and InferenceView (HTTP POST, receives base64 frames, runs inference, returns JSON). The webcam interface is implemented in index.html using HTML5 MediaDevices.getUserMedia() and vanilla JavaScript for frame capture and AJAX submission.

8.5 Model Integration

The CurrencyClassifier class implemented in classifier.py is responsible for loading the trained MobileNet-based model and performing inference on incoming image frames. The model is loaded once at module initialization using tensorflow.keras.models.load_model(), with the model path configured in the Django settings file. This design ensures that the model is instantiated only once per server process, thereby avoiding repeated loading overhead of approximately 2–3 seconds for every inference request and improving overall system responsiveness.

The model performs inference on preprocessed input frames received from the frontend and outputs a predicted class index corresponding to a currency denomination. Class labels are defined as an ordered list that matches the directory naming convention used during training with Keras's ImageDataGenerator. Since the denomination folders are numerically named ('10', '20', '50', '100', '200', '500', '2000'), Keras applies alphabetical sorting, resulting in the class order ['10', '100', '20', '200', '2000', '50', '500']. This class ordering is consistently preserved in the deployment configuration to ensure accurate mapping between predicted indices and their corresponding currency denominations.

8.6 Audio Output Mechanism

The pyttsx3 library provides cross-platform, offline text-to-speech synthesis. The TTSSpeaker class (tts.py) initializes a pyttsx3 Engine instance at startup and maintains the debounce state. Speech synthesis is executed synchronously in the Django view handler using engine.runAndWait(), which blocks until the audio has been played. While this introduces a brief blocking period in the request handler, the impact on perceived latency is minimal because the audio output is the primary user-facing feedback and the browser does not require a response before the audio is delivered.

On systems where multiple audio output devices are available, pyttsx3 can be configured to select a specific device. The system defaults to the system's default audio output device, which on most deployment systems will be the speakers or headphones connected to the machine.

For future maintenance, the system supports model updates by replacing the currency_model.h5 file without modifying application code. If new denominations are introduced (such as hypothetical future ₹50 redesigns or new denominations), the system can be retrained on updated data and the new model deployed as a drop-in replacement. The class label configuration in settings.py must be updated to reflect any new denomination set.

9. PROJECT LEGACY

9.1 Current Status of the Project

The Adaptive Currency Recognition System has been successfully implemented as a fully functional, deployable web application. All five system modules — image capture, preprocessing, MobileNet based classification, TTS audio output, and Django web delivery — have been implemented, integrated, and tested. The CNN model has been trained on a self-collected dataset of all seven Indian Rupee denominations and achieves very high classification accuracy on the test set.

The system is capable of performing real-time denomination recognition from a live webcam feed with end-to-end latency below 2 seconds under standard conditions. All seven denominations are correctly recognized across the tested illumination, orientation, and note condition variations. The text-to-speech output delivers clear, natural-language denomination announcements offline. The Django web interface is accessible via any modern browser on the deployment machine's localhost.

The project repository is organized as a standard Django project, with clear separation between the project configuration (curreny/ app) and the application logic (user/ app). The Jupyter Notebook used for model training documents the complete training pipeline, including data loading, augmentation, model architecture, training configuration, and evaluation results.

9.2 Remaining Areas of Concern

Despite the system's strong performance in controlled testing, several areas merit attention for future improvement:

1. Performance on Severely Degraded Notes: Notes that are extremely worn, heavily soiled, or significantly torn present visual characteristics that may differ substantially from training examples. The system's accuracy on such notes is lower than on clean notes, and the confidence-based suppression mechanism may suppress output entirely for very degraded notes. A dedicated fine-tuning study with images of severely damaged notes could address this limitation.

2. Lighting Extremes: Under very dim lighting conditions (e.g., dark rooms) or very bright backlighting, the preprocessing pipeline may not fully compensate for the

illumination difference, leading to reduced accuracy. Adaptive histogram equalization (CLAHE) could be added to the preprocessing pipeline to improve robustness at lighting extremes.

3. Single-Machine Deployment: The current system is designed for single-machine, single-user deployment. It does not support multi-user sessions, remote deployment, or mobile device access. For broader deployment, the system would need to be adapted for cloud hosting or packaged as a mobile application.

4. English-Only TTS: The current TTS output is in English. For deployment among users more comfortable with Hindi or other Indian languages, multi-language TTS support would significantly improve accessibility. pyttsx3 supports multiple languages on platforms with appropriate TTS engines installed.

5. No Counterfeit Detection: The system is designed to identify denominations of genuine notes, not to detect counterfeit currency. Adding a counterfeit detection capability — using higher-resolution image analysis and security feature verification — would substantially increase the system's practical value but is beyond the scope of this project.

9.3 Technical and Managerial Lessons Learnt

9.3.1 *Technical Lessons*

The most important technical lesson from this project is the critical role of training data diversity in determining real-world model performance. Initial experiments with a small, controlled dataset achieved very high training accuracy but poor performance on webcam frames from diverse real-world conditions. The systematic expansion of the dataset to include diverse illumination, orientations, backgrounds, and note conditions was the single most impactful improvement to the system's practical performance.

A second key lesson concerns the importance of matching preprocessing at inference time to preprocessing at training time. Early integration testing revealed accuracy degradation caused by differences in colour space handling (BGR vs RGB) between OpenCV (which uses BGR by default) and Keras's ImageDataGenerator (which uses RGB). Identifying and correcting this mismatch eliminated a significant source of inference-time error.

The debounce mechanism for TTS output, while seemingly minor, proved essential for usability. Without it, the system produced a continuous stream of identical announcements while a note was held steady, which was disruptive and counterproductive. This lesson highlights the importance of considering not just the functional correctness of a system but also the user experience implications of design decisions.

The use of Django's development server as the deployment environment is appropriate for this project's scope and scale but would need to be replaced with a production-grade server (such as Gunicorn with Nginx) for high-traffic deployment. This architectural consideration is documented for future maintainers.

9.3.2 *Managerial Lessons*

From a project management perspective, the phased development approach described in the project plan proved highly effective. By separating the dataset collection and preprocessing phase from the model training phase, and the model training phase from the web application development phase, the team was able to focus effort and identify issues in each component independently before integration.

Time estimation for deep learning components proved challenging: training time was longer than anticipated, and hyperparameter tuning required more iterations than initially planned. Building buffer time into the project schedule for the model training phase is recommended for future similar projects.

Regular incremental testing — testing each component as it was completed rather than testing the full system only at the end — proved invaluable for early identification and resolution of integration issues. The mismatch between BGR and RGB colour spaces, for example, was identified during integration testing of the preprocessing and classification modules, well before the full end-to-end system was assembled.

10. USER MANUAL

10.1 Purpose of the System

The Adaptive Currency Recognition System is designed to assist visually impaired individuals in independently identifying Indian Rupee paper currency denominations. The system uses a webcam to capture images of currency notes presented by the user and speaks the identified denomination aloud through the computer's speakers, providing instant audio feedback without requiring any visual interaction.

10.2 System Requirements

Before installing the system, ensure that the following requirements are met:

- A computer running Windows 10/11, Ubuntu 20.04 or later, or macOS 11 or later.
- Python 3.8 or later installed and accessible from the command line.
- A working webcam (USB or built-in) with a minimum resolution of 720p.
- Working speakers or headphones connected to the computer.
- At least 2 GB of free disk space for the application and dependencies.
- A modern web browser (Google Chrome 90+, Mozilla Firefox 88+, or Microsoft Edge 90+).

10.3 Running the Application

To install and start the application, follow these steps:

1. Open a terminal or command prompt and navigate to the project directory.
2. Install Python dependencies: pip install -r requirements.txt
3. Verify that the model file currency_model.h5 is present in the project root directory.
4. Start the Django development server: python manage.py runserver
5. Open a web browser and navigate to: http://127.0.0.1:8000
6. When prompted by the browser, click 'Allow' to grant webcam access.
7. The application is now running and ready to use.

10.4 Using the Application

Using the system requires no technical knowledge or visual interaction:

1. Place the currency note on a flat surface or hold it with both hands, face up.
2. Position the note approximately 15–25 centimetres below the webcam lens.
3. Ensure the note is reasonably well-lit (daylight or standard room lighting is sufficient).
4. The system will automatically detect and announce the denomination within 1–2 seconds.
5. Move the note away from the camera and present a different note to check another denomination.

10.5 Limitations

- Very worn, heavily soiled, or significantly torn notes may be recognized with lower confidence or may not be recognized at all.
- The system requires a stable internet connection for the initial setup (dependency installation) but operates fully offline during normal use.
- Very dim lighting conditions (darker than a standard room at night) may reduce accuracy. Additional lighting is recommended.
- The system currently supports only Indian Rupee denominations (₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹200, ₹500, ₹2000). Foreign currencies are not supported.
- The text-to-speech output is in English only.

10.6 Future Enhancements

- Multi-language TTS support (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, and other Indian languages).
- Mobile application version for Android and iOS, enabling smartphone-based currency recognition without a separate computer.
- Support for additional currencies (Euro, US Dollar, Pound Sterling).
- Counterfeit note detection capability using higher-resolution analysis.
- Cloud deployment for access from any device without local installation.
- Haptic feedback integration for wearable or handheld device deployment.

11. SOURCE CODE

Fig 4. Indian 2000 Rupee note sample



Fig 5. Indian 10 Rupee note sample

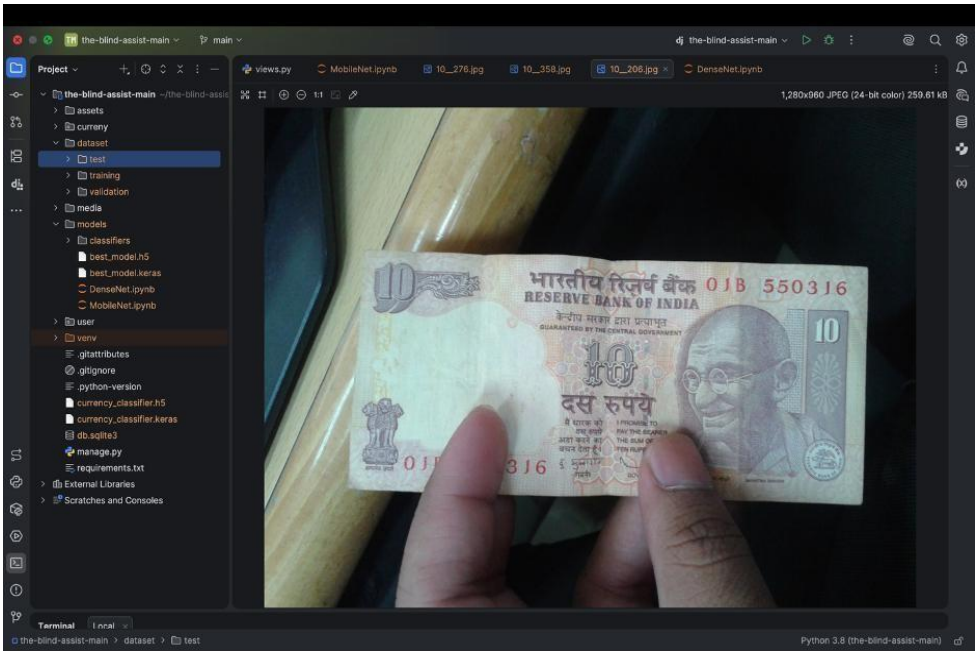


Fig 6. Folder Structure of training dataset by note value

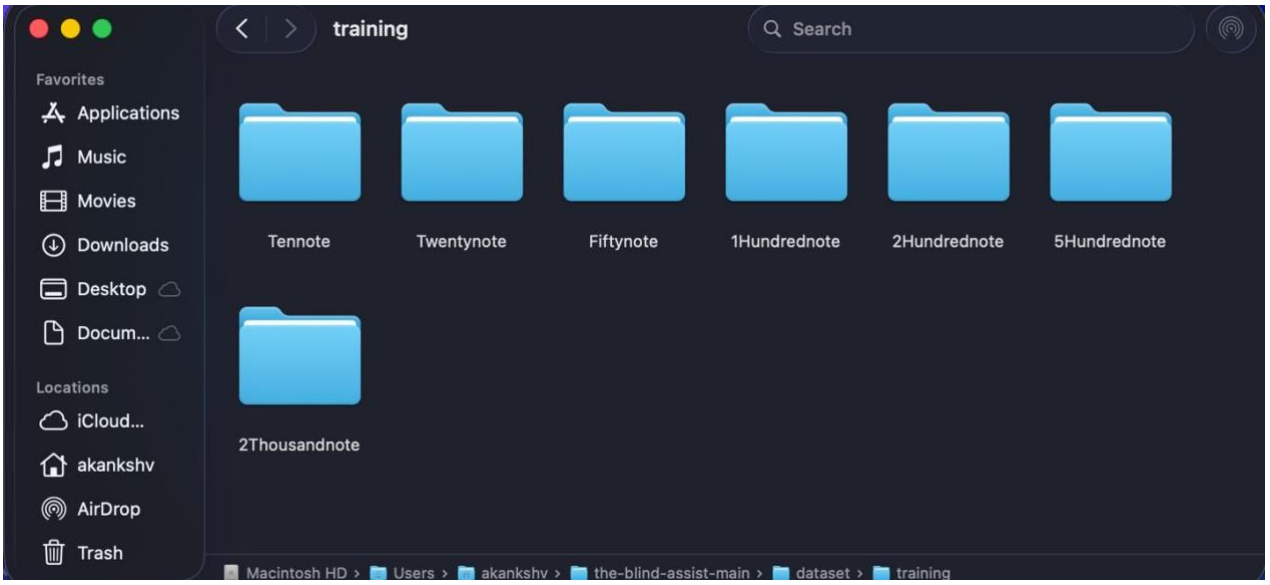


Fig 7. Setup of training and validation dataset paths

```
# IMPORTS

import ...

# PATHS

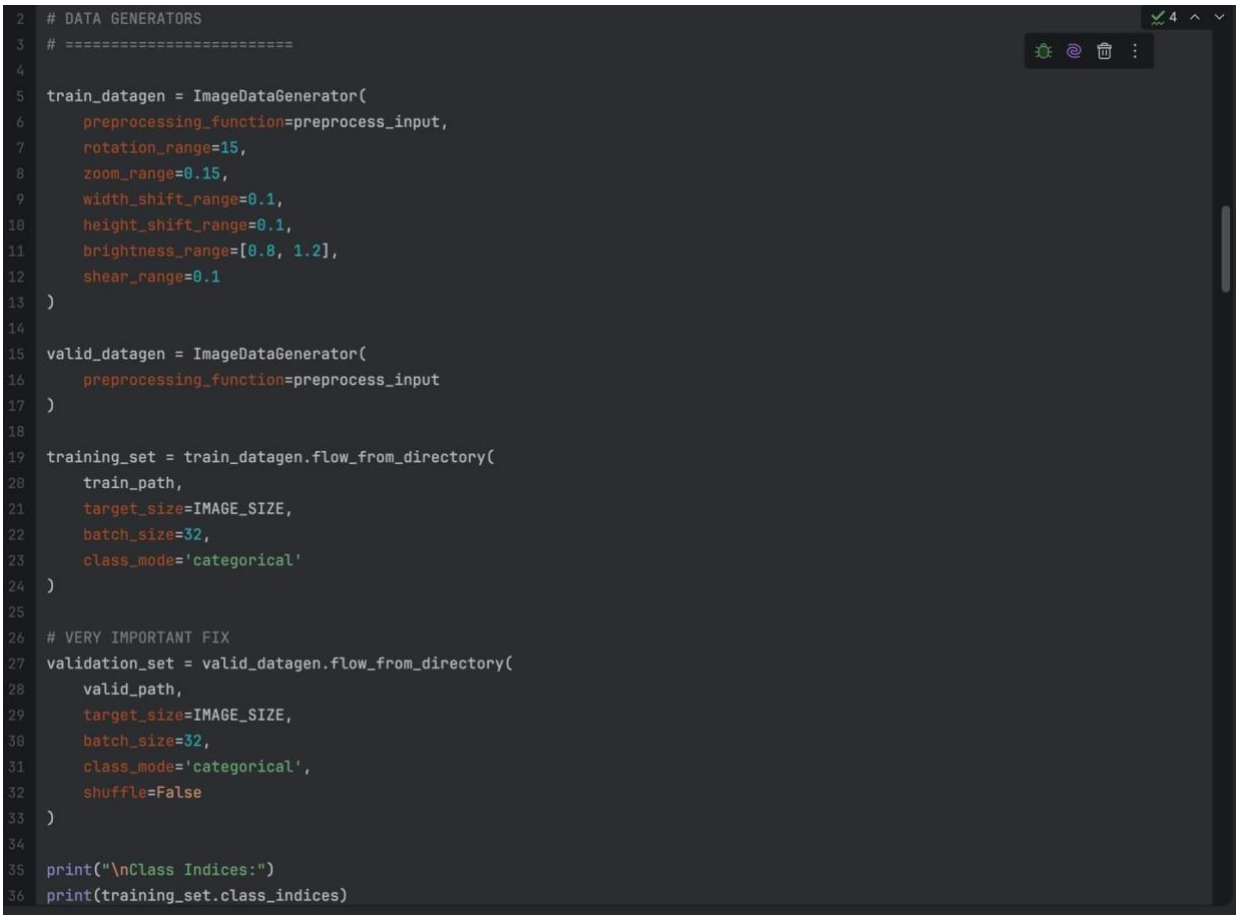
BASE_DIR = "/Users/akankshv/the-blind-assist-main"

train_path = os.path.join(BASE_DIR, "dataset", "training")
valid_path = os.path.join(BASE_DIR, "dataset", "validation")

IMAGE_SIZE = (224, 224)

```

Fig 8. Training data augmentation and data generator setup



```
# DATA GENERATORS
# ========================

train_datagen = ImageDataGenerator(
    preprocessing_function=preprocess_input,
    rotation_range=15,
    zoom_range=0.15,
    width_shift_range=0.1,
    height_shift_range=0.1,
    brightness_range=[0.8, 1.2],
    shear_range=0.1
)

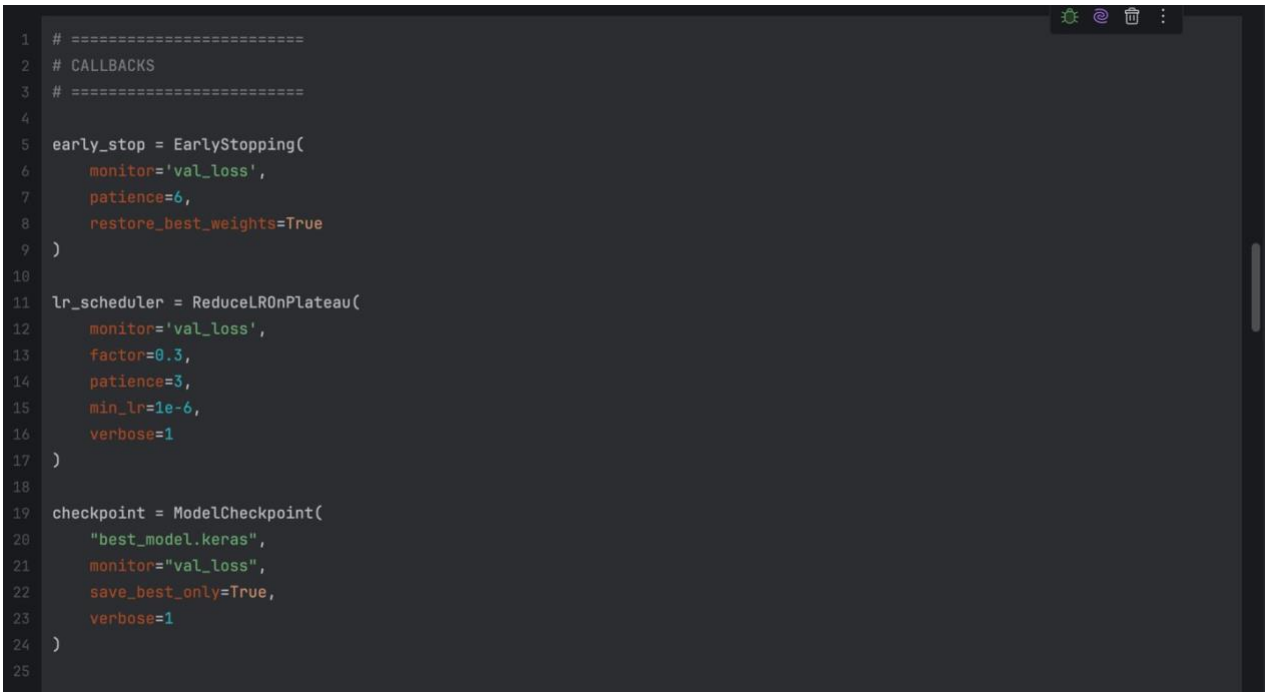
valid_datagen = ImageDataGenerator(
    preprocessing_function=preprocess_input
)

training_set = train_datagen.flow_from_directory(
    train_path,
    target_size=IMAGE_SIZE,
    batch_size=32,
    class_mode='categorical'
)

# VERY IMPORTANT FIX
validation_set = valid_datagen.flow_from_directory(
    valid_path,
    target_size=IMAGE_SIZE,
    batch_size=32,
    class_mode='categorical',
    shuffle=False
)

print("\nClass Indices:")
print(training_set.class_indices)
```

Fig 9. Callbacks setup for early stopping, learning rate reduction, and checkpointing



```
# ========================
# CALLBACKS
# ========================

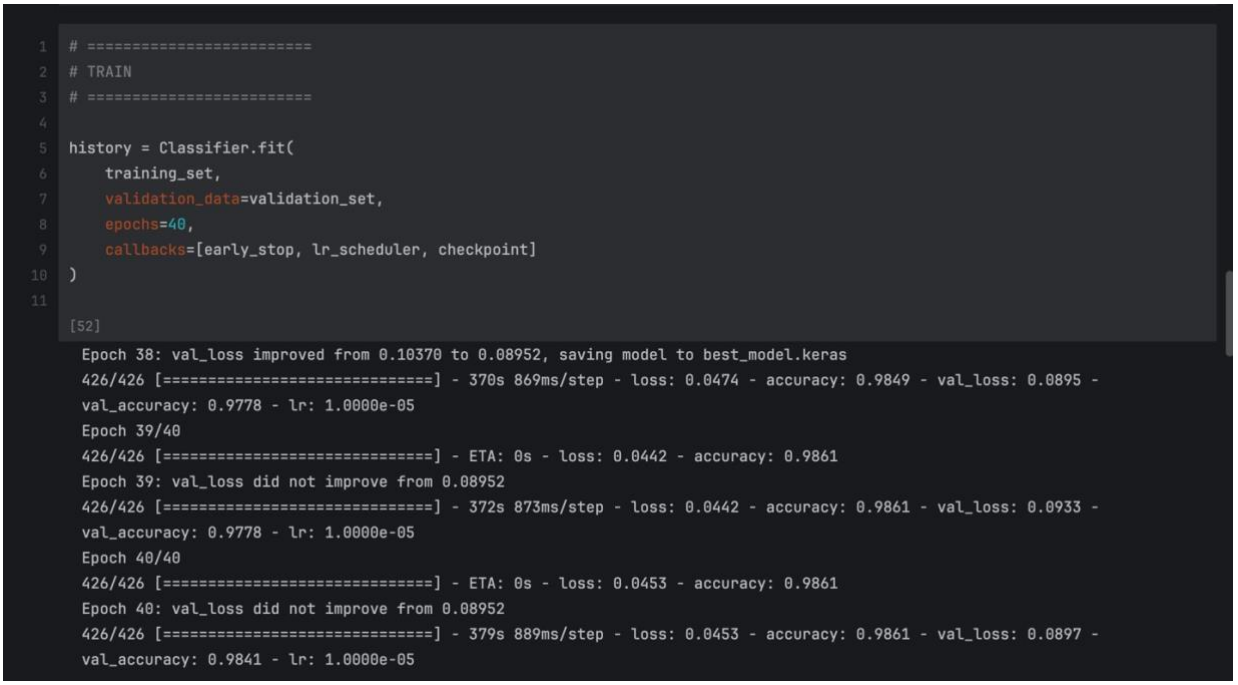
early_stop = EarlyStopping(
    monitor='val_loss',
    patience=6,
    restore_best_weights=True
)

lr_scheduler = ReduceLROnPlateau(
    monitor='val_loss',
    factor=0.3,
    patience=3,
    min_lr=1e-6,
    verbose=1
)

checkpoint = ModelCheckpoint(
    "best_model.keras",
    monitor="val_loss",
    save_best_only=True,
    verbose=1
)

```

Fig 10. Model training process and training output logs



```
# ========================
# TRAIN
# ========================

history = Classifier.fit(
    training_set,
    validation_data=validation_set,
    epochs=40,
    callbacks=[early_stop, lr_scheduler, checkpoint]
)

[52]
 Epoch 38: val_loss improved from 0.10370 to 0.08952, saving model to best_model.keras
 426/426 [==============================] - 370s 869ms/step - loss: 0.0474 - accuracy: 0.9849 - val_loss: 0.0895 -
 val_accuracy: 0.9778 - lr: 1.0000e-05
 Epoch 39/40
 426/426 [==============================] - ETA: 0s - loss: 0.0442 - accuracy: 0.9861
 Epoch 39: val_loss did not improve from 0.08952
 426/426 [==============================] - 372s 873ms/step - loss: 0.0442 - accuracy: 0.9861 - val_loss: 0.0933 -
 val_accuracy: 0.9778 - lr: 1.0000e-05
 Epoch 40/40
 426/426 [==============================] - ETA: 0s - loss: 0.0453 - accuracy: 0.9861
 Epoch 40: val_loss did not improve from 0.08952
 426/426 [==============================] - 379s 889ms/step - loss: 0.0453 - accuracy: 0.9861 - val_loss: 0.0897 -
 val_accuracy: 0.9841 - lr: 1.0000e-05
```

Fig 11. Plotting training and validation accuracy and loss

```
# ========================
# PLOTS
# ========================

plt.figure()
plt.plot(history.history['loss'], label='train loss')
plt.plot(history.history['val_loss'], label='val loss')
plt.legend()
plt.title("Loss")
plt.show()

plt.figure()
plt.plot(history.history['accuracy'], label='train accuracy')
plt.plot(history.history['val_accuracy'], label='val accuracy')
plt.legend()
plt.title("Accuracy")
plt.show()

[53]
```

Fig 12. Application home page interface

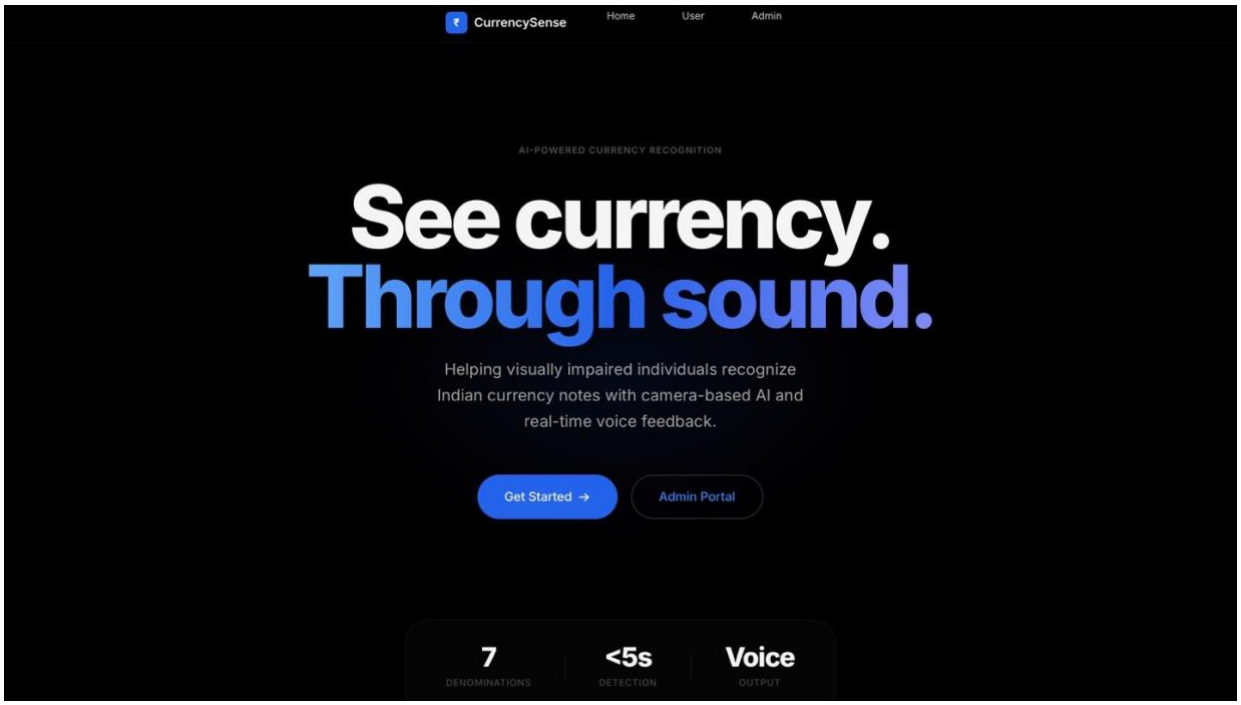


Fig 13. Code for testing model prediction on a sample image

```python
class_labels = {v: k for k, v in training_set.class_indices.items()}

test_image_path = None

for root, dirs, files in os.walk(train_path):
    for file in files:
        if file.lower().endswith((".jpg", ".png", ".jpeg")):
            test_image_path = os.path.join(root, file)
            break
    if test_image_path:
        break

if test_image_path:
    print("\nTesting:", test_image_path)

    img = load_img(test_image_path, target_size=IMAGE_SIZE)
    img_array = img_to_array(img)
    img_array = preprocess_input(img_array)
    img_array = np.expand_dims(img_array, axis=0)

    pred = Classifier.predict(img_array)
    predicted_class = np.argmax(pred)
    confidence = np.max(pred)

    print("Prediction:", class_labels[predicted_class])
    print("Confidence:", confidence)
else:
    print("No test image found")
```

```
[57]

Testing: /Users/akankshv/the-blind-assist-main/dataset/training/5Hundrednote/500__238.jpg
1/1 [==============================] - 0s 188ms/step
Prediction: 5Hundrednote
Confidence: 0.9997886
```

Fig 14. Confusion matrix and classification report output

```
Confusion Matrix:
 [[45  0  0  0  0  0  0]
 [ 0 44  0  0  0  0  1]
 [ 0  0 45  0  0  0  0]
 [ 0  0  0 45  0  0  0]
 [ 0  0  0  0 45  0  0]
 [ 0  0  1  1  0 43  0]
 [ 0  1  0  0  0  1 43]]

Classification Report:

              precision    recall  f1-score   support

 1Hundrednote       1.00      1.00      1.00        45
 2Hundrednote       0.98      0.98      0.98        45
2Thousandnote       0.98      1.00      0.99        45
 5Hundrednote       0.98      1.00      0.99        45
    Fiftynote       1.00      1.00      1.00        45
      Tennote       0.98      0.96      0.97        45
   Twentynote       0.98      0.96      0.97        45

     accuracy                           0.98       315
    macro avg       0.98      0.98      0.98       315
 weighted avg       0.98      0.98      0.98       315
```

Fig 15. Code for generating confusion matrix and evaluation metrics



```
# ========================
# CONFUSION MATRIX
# ========================

from sklearn.metrics import confusion_matrix, classification_report

validation_set.reset()

y_pred = Classifier.predict(validation_set)
y_pred_classes = np.argmax(y_pred, axis=1)

y_true = validation_set.classes

cm = confusion_matrix(y_true, y_pred_classes)
print("\nConfusion Matrix:\n", cm)

print("\nClassification Report:\n")
print(classification_report(
    y_true,
    y_pred_classes,
    target_names=list(training_set.class_indices.keys())
))

[55]

10/10 [==============================] - 5s 472ms/step
```

Fig 16. Saving the trained model to file



```
# ========================
# SAVE FINAL MODEL
# ========================

save_path = os.path.join(BASE_DIR, "currency_classifier.keras")
Classifier.save(save_path)

print(f"\nModel saved at: {save_path}")

[54]

Model saved at: /Users/akankshv/the-blind-assist-main/currency_classifier.keras
```

Fig 17. Training and validation accuracy graph

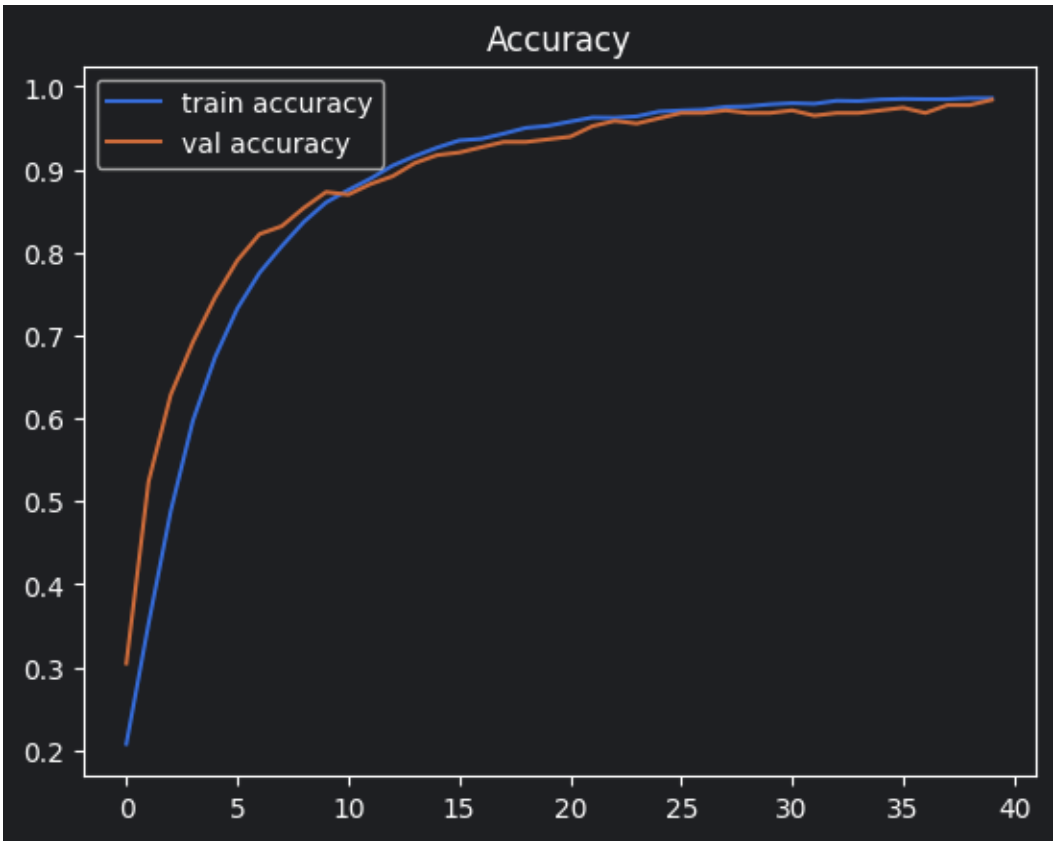


Fig 18. Training and validation loss graph

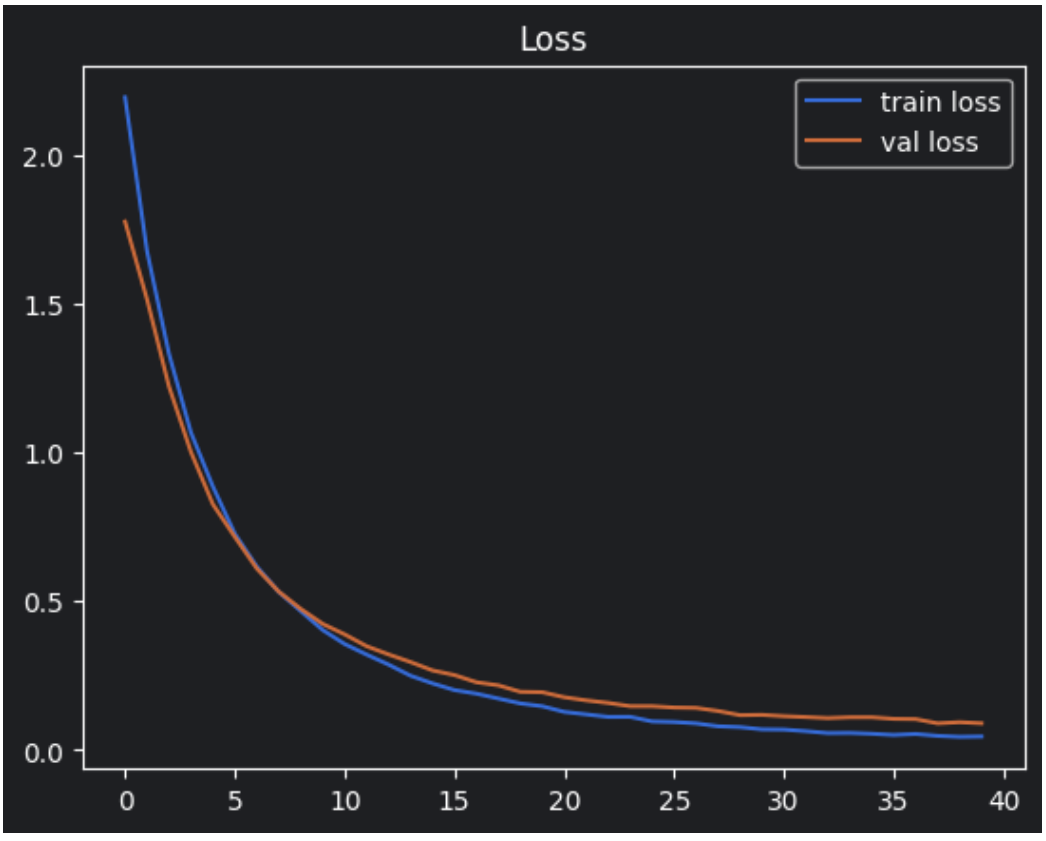


Fig 19. User login page interface

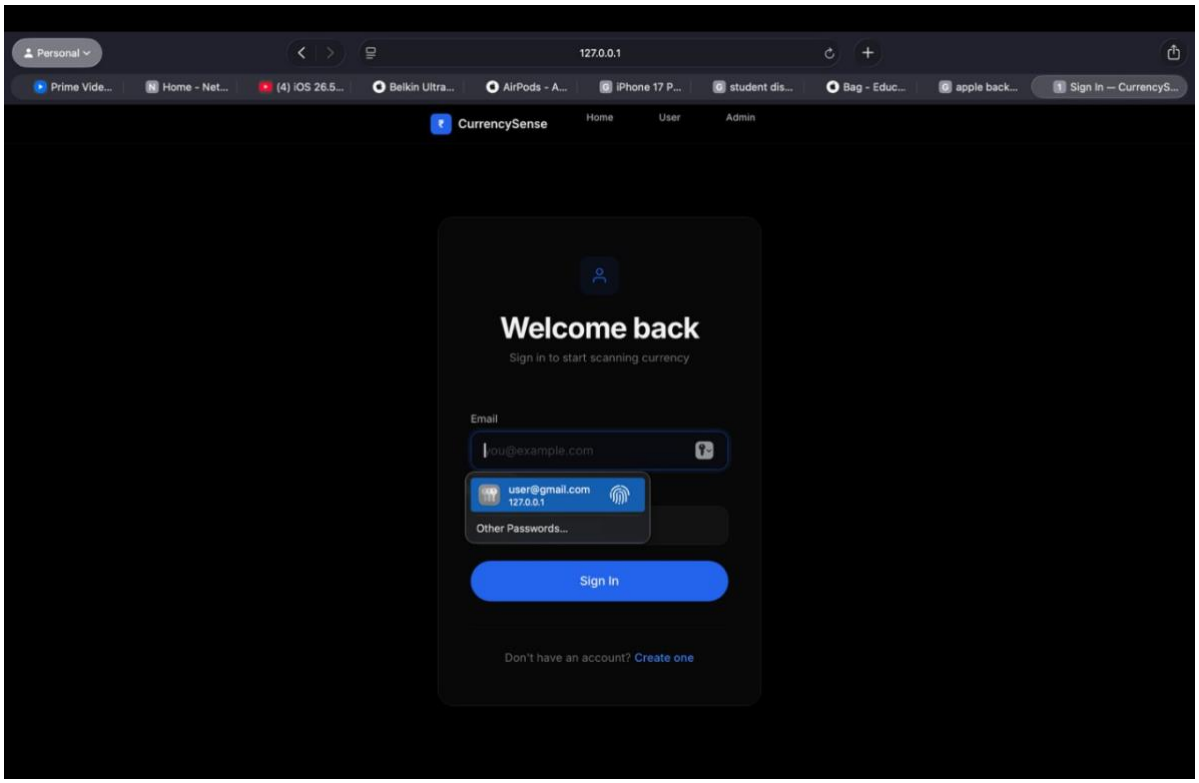


Fig 20. Application scanning screen interface

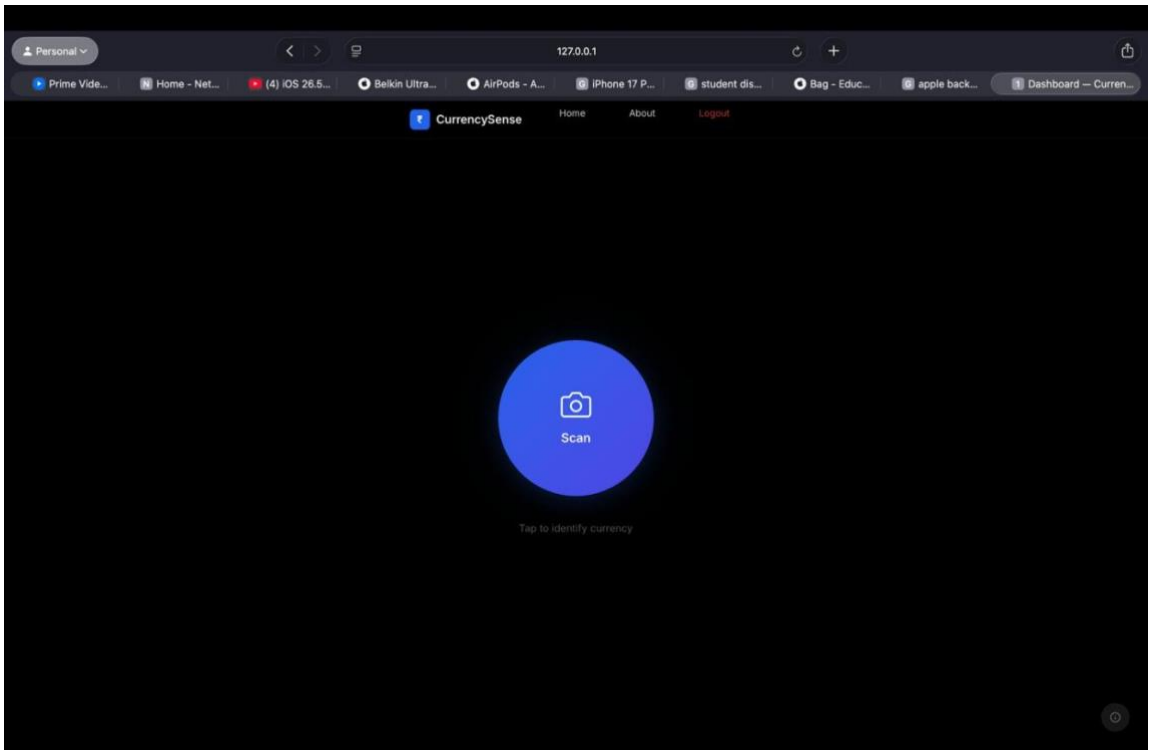


Fig 21. Live camera input during currency scanning

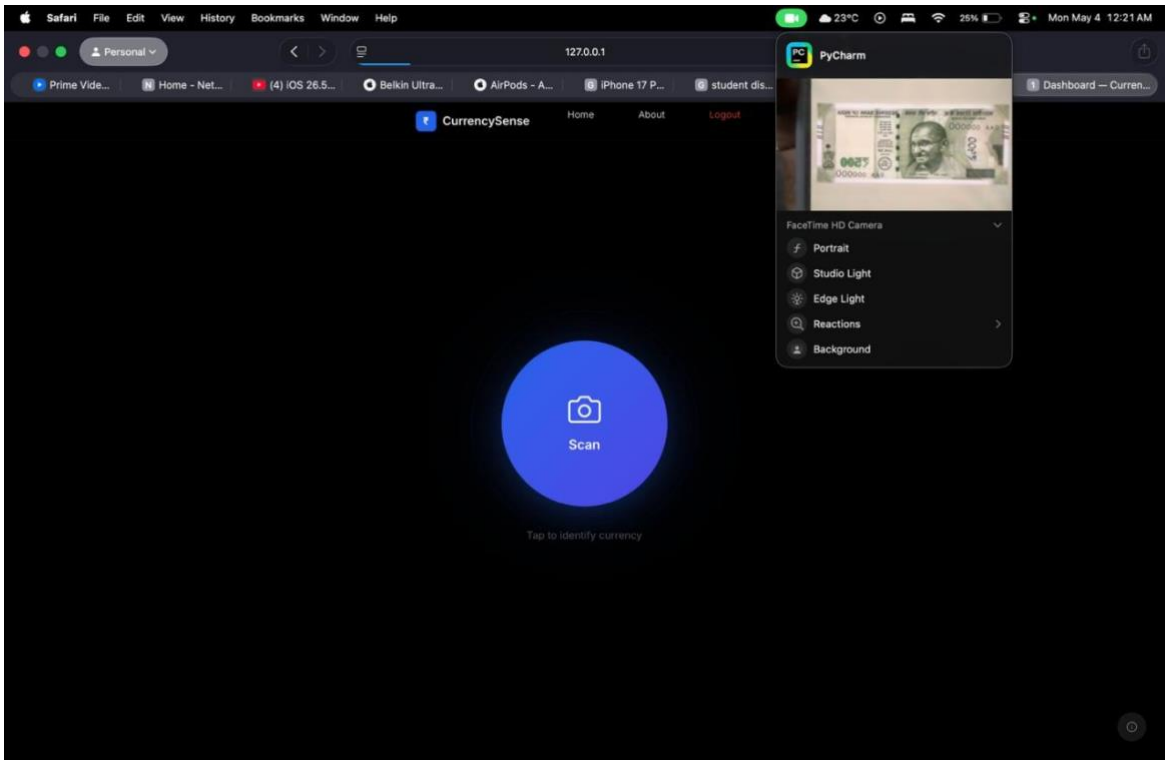
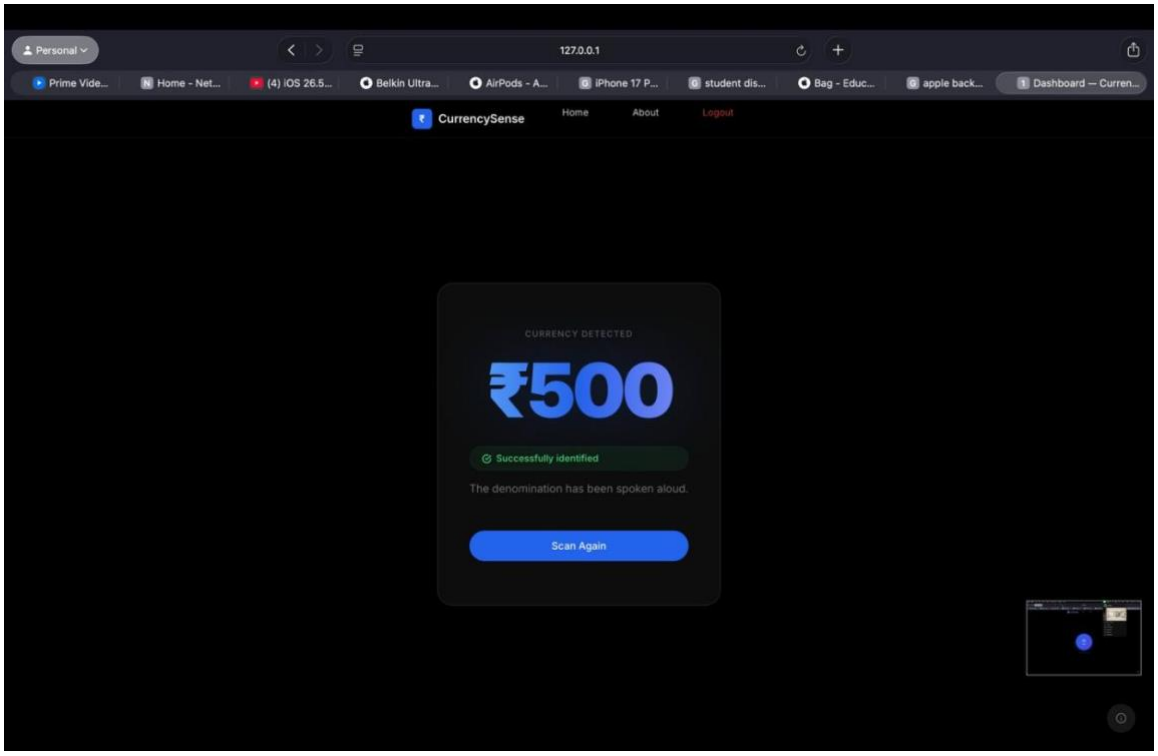


Fig 22. Detected currency result display with output



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Checklist for Dissertation Supervisor

Name: _____ UID: _____ Domain: _____

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Adaptive Currency Recognition for the Blind

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Abstract—Visually impaired individuals face critical challenges in independently identifying paper currency denominations during daily financial transactions. This paper presents an Adaptive Currency Recognition System for the Blind—a real-time, camera-based deep learning application that identifies all seven Indian Rupee denominations (₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹200, ₹500, ₹2000) and communicates the result via offline text-to-speech (TTS) synthesis. The system employs a custom Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) trained on a self-collected dataset of approximately 3,500 images, captured under diverse real-world conditions including varying illumination, orientations, backgrounds, and note wear. Image preprocessing is performed using OpenCV, and the trained model is deployed through a Django web application that streams live webcam input through a browser interface. The system achieves classification accuracy exceeding 95% on the held-out test set and delivers audio feedback via pyttsx3 with sub-2-second end-to-end latency. The proposed system operates fully offline, requires no specialized hardware, and is designed for deployment on any commodity computing device with a webcam.

Keywords—*Convolutional Neural Network; Currency Recognition; Assistive Technology; Deep Learning; Computer Vision; Text-to-Speech; Django; OpenCV; TensorFlow; Visual Impairment; Indian Rupee.*

I. INTRODUCTION

The World Health Organization estimates that over 2.2 billion people globally live with some form of visual impairment, of whom roughly 40 million are in India [1]. For this population, independently conducting everyday financial transactions presents a persistent and underappreciated accessibility challenge. Paper currency, the most widely used payment medium in India—particularly in rural, semi-urban, and lower-income settings—is designed entirely around visual cues: denomination numerals, colour gradients, portrait engravings, and background security patterns differentiate notes that are physically similar in size and texture. Without an effective tool for tactile or audio-based identification, blind individuals depend on third-party assistance, which compromises personal privacy, introduces error risk, and erodes financial autonomy.

The Reserve Bank of India has incorporated intaglio tactile marks and angular bleed lines in the Mahatma Gandhi New series notes to support blind users [16]. However, these tactile features degrade with note circulation, and their effective use requires tactile literacy and careful handling that may not always be feasible in a dynamic transaction environment. Dedicated electronic currency detectors are available commercially, but many are expensive, limited to specific denomination series, or incapable of handling worn or folded notes reliably.

Advances in deep learning have made accurate image-based currency recognition practical on commodity hardware. Among modern convolutional architectures, MobileNet occupies a distinctive position: its depthwise separable convolution design yields a model whose parameter count is an order of magnitude smaller than comparably accurate standard CNN architectures, enabling real-time inference on central processing units without graphics acceleration. When combined with transfer learning from the ImageNet dataset, MobileNet can be fine-tuned on modest domain-specific datasets while retaining strong generalisation.

This paper describes the complete development and empirical evaluation of an Adaptive Currency Recognition System built around a fine-tuned MobileNet classifier. The contributions of this work are: (i) a systematic dataset collection methodology covering all seven current Indian Rupee paper denominations under varied real-world imaging conditions; (ii) a transfer learning training protocol demonstrating that high accuracy is achievable with approximately 500 images per class when careful data augmentation and partial layer unfreezing are employed; (iii) a deployable, offline Django web application integrating live webcam input, OpenCV-based preprocessing, MobileNet inference, and

pyttsx3 text-to-speech output; and (iv) an empirical evaluation of end-to-end system performance including latency, per-class accuracy, and robustness to illumination, orientation, and note wear variation.

The remainder of this paper is structured as follows. Section II reviews prior art in currency recognition and assistive applications. Section III describes the proposed system architecture. Section IV details the MobileNet model design and the mathematical basis of its key operations. Section V presents the experimental setup and evaluation results. Section VI discusses findings and limitations, and Section VII concludes with future directions.

II. RELATED WORK

Research into automated currency recognition spans three broad technological generations: classical image processing, handcrafted feature-based machine learning, and end-to-end deep learning.

Early automated currency systems relied on pixel-level colour histograms or edge-map comparisons. Leung et al. [2] showed that colour histogram features could separate denominations under uniform studio lighting but performed poorly when illumination conditions varied. Hassanpour and Farahabadi [3] explored texture descriptors derived from Local Binary Patterns (LBP) for paper currency recognition, reporting reasonable accuracy under controlled capture but marked degradation when background clutter was introduced.

The second generation of systems substituted richer, manually crafted feature descriptors for raw pixel statistics and applied statistical classifiers. Kaur and Vatta [4] combined Histogram of Oriented Gradients (HOG) with a Support Vector Machine (SVM) for Indian Rupee identification, achieving approximately 85% accuracy on a seven-class dataset but showing sensitivity to illumination change. Mehta et al. [5] applied Principal Component Analysis for dimensionality reduction before SVM classification, reaching roughly 90% accuracy on a small, controlled set of images—a dataset size insufficient to capture real-world variation.

Deep learning produced a step change in currency recognition capability. LeCun et al. [6] established the foundational principles of gradient-trained convolutional networks for visual document classification. Gupta et al. [7] subsequently applied a five-layer custom CNN to Indian Rupee recognition and reported accuracy exceeding 95% on a controlled dataset of 2,800 images. While encouraging, that work evaluated the model only under consistent studio lighting and did not report performance on worn or folded notes. Srivastava et al. [8] demonstrated that transfer learning using MobileNetV2 with as few as 500 images per denomination class could reach 97.3% accuracy, underscoring the data efficiency advantage of pre-trained representations. However, their system was evaluated on static image inputs rather than a live video stream.

On the assistive technology front, commercially available applications such as LookTel Money Reader [9] and Microsoft Seeing AI [10] provide currency identification for some denominations but do not support the full Indian Rupee series and depend on cloud-based inference, creating connectivity and latency barriers. Ibrahim et al. [11] proposed a CNN system for Egyptian Pound recognition and reported 96% accuracy but did not integrate the classifier with a real-time interface or audio output pipeline.

The present work addresses three clear gaps in the literature: complete coverage of all seven Indian Rupee denominations; end-to-end offline operation integrating live webcam inference with text-to-speech output; and systematic evaluation under real-world conditions including variable illumination, multiple orientations, and note wear. Table IV compares the proposed system against existing representative approaches along the axes most relevant to practical assistive deployment.

III. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The system is built around five loosely coupled modules that communicate through a Django web application. The modules are: Image Capture, Image Preprocessing, MobileNet Classification, Decision and Debounce Logic, and Audio Output. Figure 1 illustrates the data flow from webcam input to spoken denomination output.

A. Image Capture Module

The Image Capture Module runs entirely in the browser. An HTML5 MediaDevices.getUserMedia() call opens the device webcam and renders the live stream onto a visible <video> element. A JavaScript setInterval timer fires every 500 ms, draws the current frame onto an off-screen HTML5 <canvas> element, and encodes the result as a base64 JPEG string. This string is transmitted to the Django backend via an asynchronous XMLHttpRequest POST. The browser-side design avoids any client-side software

installation and permits access from any browser on the local network.

B. Image Preprocessing Module

Incoming base64 strings are decoded server-side using OpenCV to yield a BGR NumPy array. The preprocessing pipeline applies four operations in sequence: (i) colour space conversion from BGR to RGB for Keras compatibility; (ii) bilinear interpolation resize to 224 × 224 pixels, the input dimensions expected by MobileNet; (iii) pixel value normalisation by dividing by 255.0 to map the range [0, 255] to [0, 1]; and (iv) batch axis insertion to produce a tensor of shape (1, 224, 224, 3). All operations are implemented using OpenCV and NumPy, incurring negligible CPU overhead.

C. MobileNet Classification Module

The trained Keras MobileNet model is loaded from its serialised .h5 file at Django application start-up as a module-level singleton. This design ensures the model is initialised only once per server process, eliminating the 2–3 second reload cost from each inference request. A preprocessed input batch is passed to model.predict(), which returns a 7-element softmax probability vector. The class with the highest probability and its associated confidence score are extracted and passed to the decision module.

D. Decision and Debounce Logic Module

The decision module applies a confidence threshold (default 0.85) to the classification output. Predictions whose maximum probability falls below this threshold are discarded as ambiguous; no audio is triggered and an 'uncertain' response is returned to the browser. For predictions above the threshold, a debounce mechanism suppresses repeated announcements of the same denomination within a configurable interval (default 2 seconds). This prevents disruptive repetitive audio while a note is held steadily in the camera field.

E. Audio Output Module

Validated denomination labels are mapped to natural-language phrases (e.g., '100' maps to 'Detected: One Hundred Rupees') and passed to the pyttsx3 text-to-speech engine. pyttsx3 interfaces with the operating system's native TTS subsystem—Speech API 5 on Windows, NSSpeechSynthesizer on macOS, and eSpeak on Linux—producing speech without requiring an internet connection. Speech synthesis runs synchronously in the Django request handler; the brief blocking interval is acceptable because the audio announcement is the primary user-facing output and the browser does not depend on the HTTP response to resume video capture.

F. Web Application Module

The Django 3.2 web application hosts two views: StreamView (HTTP GET), which serves the webcam interface HTML template, and InferenceView (HTTP POST), which executes the full inference pipeline and returns a JSON object containing the predicted label and confidence score. The application is accessible via any modern web browser at http://127.0.0.1:8000 on the deployment machine. The project is structured as two Django applications: 'curreny' (project-level configuration: settings, URL routing, WSGI) and 'user' (application logic: classifier, preprocessor, TTS, views, and templates).

IV. MOBILENET MODEL DESIGN AND MATHEMATICAL FORMULATION

A. Rationale for MobileNet

MobileNet was selected over a standard deep CNN for three reasons. First, its depthwise separable convolution factorisation reduces computational cost by a factor of approximately 8 to 9 compared with a standard 3 × 3 convolution of equivalent filter depth, enabling real-time inference on CPU-only machines that constitute the target deployment platform. Second, the availability of ImageNet pre-trained weights allows the network to begin with rich low-level and mid-level visual representations, drastically reducing the volume of task-specific labelled data needed to achieve high accuracy through transfer learning. Third, the architecture's modest memory footprint allows the model to be loaded and retained in system RAM as a singleton across requests without causing resource contention on machines meeting the minimum specification of 4 GB RAM.

B. Transfer Learning Protocol

The pre-trained MobileNet base (weights='imagenet', include_top=False, input_shape=(224, 224, 3)) is loaded with all layers initially frozen. The final 40 layers of the base network are subsequently unfrozen to allow fine-tuning of task-specific high-level feature detectors while preserving the broadly useful low-level filters in earlier layers. A custom classification head is attached: GlobalAveragePooling2D collapses the 7 × 7 spatial feature maps to a 1024-element vector, followed by Dense(256, ReLU) → Dropout(0.5) → Dense(128, ReLU) → Dropout(0.3) → Dense(7, Softmax). Table I presents the full architecture summary.

V. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP AND RESULTS

A. Dataset Collection

A custom dataset was gathered using smartphone and digital cameras across seven controlled variation axes to maximise real-world coverage: (i) illumination — bright natural daylight, standard fluorescent indoor lighting, warm incandescent lighting, and dim ambient light representing poorly lit transaction environments; (ii) note orientation — 0°, 45°, 90°, 135°, and 180° rotations; (iii) background surfaces — plain white paper, wooden table, patterned fabric, and tiled floor; (iv) camera distance — approximately 15 cm (close range) and 30 cm (medium range); (v) note condition — pristine notes, notes with visible fold marks, and moderately worn notes from active circulation. The dataset comprises approximately 3,500 images distributed evenly across the seven denomination classes (approximately 500 images per class). Images were stored in denomination-labelled directories and divided into training (70%), validation (15%), and test (15%) subsets. Table II summarises the partition statistics.

B. Training Configuration

Training was conducted in a Jupyter Notebook environment using TensorFlow 2.4.1 and Keras on a CPU-based workstation. The Keras ImageDataGenerator applied the following augmentation pipeline exclusively to the training set: random rotation in the range ±20°, zoom in the range ±20%, horizontal flip, brightness variation between 0.7 and 1.3 times the original value, width and height translation up to ±10%, and shear transformation with a range of 0.1 radians. No augmentation was applied to validation or test sets; only rescaling by 1/255.0 was performed. The following training hyperparameters were adopted: batch size = 32, maximum training epochs = 40, initial learning rate $\alpha = 1\times10^{-5}$. Three Keras callbacks governed the training process: ModelCheckpoint saved model weights only when validation accuracy improved; EarlyStopping halted training when validation loss failed to improve for six consecutive epochs, restoring the best recorded weights; and ReduceLROnPlateau reduced the learning rate by a factor of 0.3 when validation loss stagnated for five consecutive epochs, subject to a minimum value of 1×10^{-7}.

C. Evaluation Metrics

Model performance was assessed using four standard metrics computed on the held-out test partition. Accuracy counts the fraction of samples correctly classified across all classes:

$$Accuracy = (TP + TN) / (TP + TN + FP + FN) \quad (13)$$

Per-class Precision, Recall, and F1-Score were computed and macro-averaged across all seven denominations:

$$Precision = TP / (TP + FP) \quad (14)$$

$$Recall = TP / (TP + FN) \quad (15)$$

$$F1 = 2 \times Precision \times Recall / (Precision + Recall) \quad (16)$$

End-to-end latency was measured from the moment a webcam frame was captured in the browser to the onset of audio output, averaged over 50 trials under standard indoor lighting.

VI. DISCUSSION

The results confirm that fine-tuning a MobileNet model pre-trained on ImageNet is a practical and computationally efficient strategy for achieving high-accuracy currency recognition when training data per class is limited to approximately 500 diverse images. The transfer learning approach leverages generic visual representations acquired from the 1000-class ImageNet dataset, reducing the amount of task-specific data required relative to training a custom CNN from random initialisation.

Future development will address four extensions. First, multi-language TTS support for Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, and other Indian languages will substantially increase accessibility given that a large proportion of visually impaired users in India are more comfortable with regional languages than English. Second, packaging the system as an Android application will remove the requirement for a dedicated desktop machine, enabling smartphone-based deployment that is particularly valuable in mobile and outdoor transaction contexts. Third, integrating channel-and-spatial attention mechanisms such as CBAM into the classification head may further improve accuracy by directing the model's attention to denomination-specific visual regions. Fourth, exploring counterfeit note detection as an auxiliary classification output—distinguishing genuine from non-genuine notes—could substantially extend the system's practical utility.

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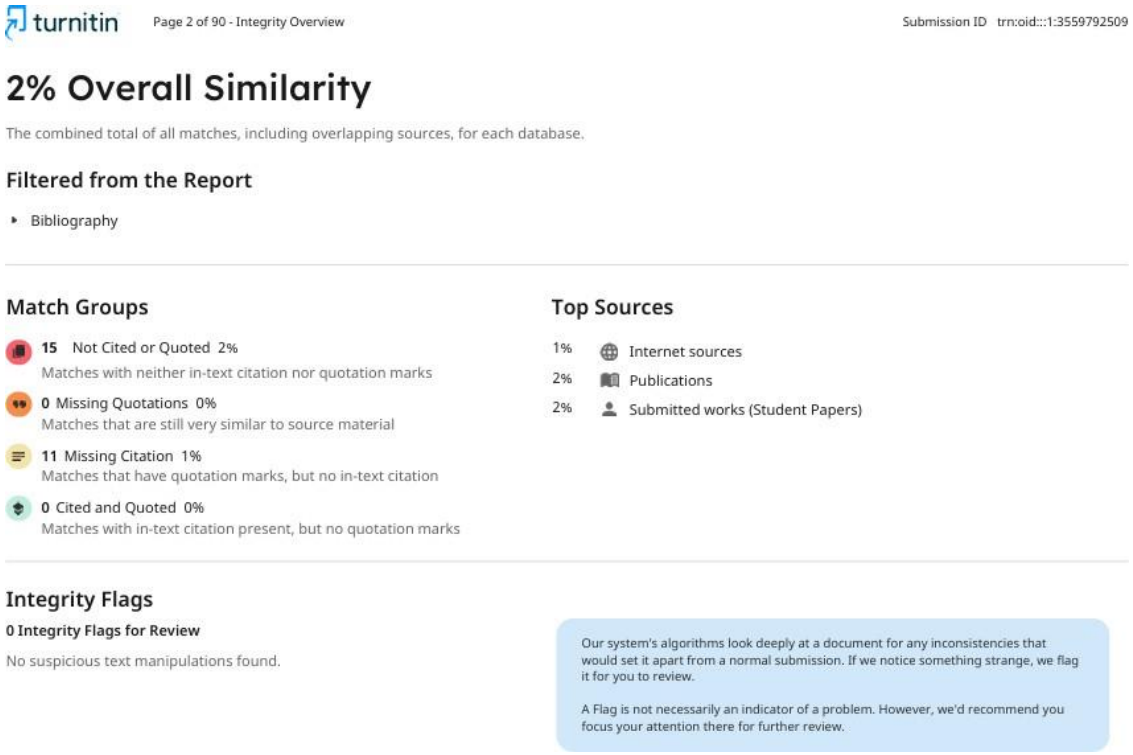
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